MARVEL
MULTIVERSE
ROLE-PLAYING GAME
SPIDER-MAN
MIDTOWN MAYHEM
ONE-SHOT ADVENTURE

MARVEL

MULTIVERSE ROLE-PLAYING GAME

SPIDER-MAN MIDTOWN MAYHEM

SPIDER-MAN MIDTOWN MAYHEM COMIC

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The *Marvel Multiverse Role-Playing Game* uses the d616 game engine.
See **Marvel.com/rpg** for more details.

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TIMES SQUARE.
:HUFF: R-RUN! :HUFF:
HE'S COMING!
STOP SHOVING, YOU'RE GONNA--
OH GOD.
GREEN ALERT!
HULK INCOMING! SEEK SHELTER!
WHOA, DOES THAT SAY THE HULK IS COMIN'?!
SEE, YOUR PROBLEM IS YOU DON'T HAVE NO CONVICTION.
I GOT YOU--GO!
HULK'S FRIEND RICK JONES HELD CAPTIVE BY NINJA
AIN'T ENOUGH CONVICTION IN THE WORLD TO MAKE ME FACE A HULK, LOOTER!
PFFT, NEWBIE. YOU'RE LEAVING MONEY ON THE TABLE, BUMBLER!
PREMIUM BLIND BOX!

NOTHIN' LIKE AN IMPENDING DISASTER TO CLEAR OUT THE COPS.
IT'S A BIRD! IT'S A PLANE! NO, WAIT...
OH MAN...
...IT'S THE SPIDER-MEN!
AND WE'RE ABOUT TO KICK YOUR BUTTS!
THWIP
THWIP
THWACK
NOTHING SENDS FOLKS INTO A PANIC MORE THAN A HULK ALERT.
DEFINITELY THE PERFECT TIME FOR CREEPS LIKE THESE TO TAKE ADVANTAGE OF THE CHAOS.
SHEESH, THIS IS BAD.
AT LEAST *WE* DON'T HAVE TO DEAL WITH HULK DIRECTLY--
WHOA! WE'RE GONNA HAVE TO GO THERE, AREN'T WE?
YEAH... WOULDN'T BE FRIENDLY NEIGHBORHOOD SPIDER-MEN IF WE DIDN'T.

SEVERAL THWIPS LATER.
THE HAND DOESN'T USUALLY PUSH THIS FAR SOUTH.
WHAT GAMES ARE THEY PLAYING AT?
NOTHING GOOD, THAT'S OBVIOUS.
KLUNK
THWACK
GREAT, WE'VE GOT COMPANY.
WHAT? WHO--?
A TWO-FOR-ONE SPIDEY/DAREDEVIL SPECIAL.
NOW, THAT'S A DEAL!
UGH, SPIDER-MEN.
ALWAYS A PLEASURE. Y'ALL SEEN MR. JONES?
WE HAVEN'T MADE IT INSIDE YET. OUR PLATE'S A BIT FULL AT THE MOMENT.
BLAM BLAM BLAM
GUN-SHOTS? FROM WHAT?!
NOT WHAT.

WHO.
BLAM BLAM
THE PUNISHER LOVES AN ENTRANCE, EH?
WHAT HE LOVES IS CHAOS. THAT MANIAC'S GOING TO GET MORE FOLKS HURT-- BEHIND US!
WE GOT THIS! THE HAND SURE ARE PERSISTENT, HUH?
TO FALL IN COMBAT IS ONE OF THEIR HIGHEST HONORS. LET US GIVE THEM THAT HONOR.
NO.
TIME.
FOR GAMES!
UH, I TOTALLY HAD THAT.
THWACK
WE CAN DEAL WITH THE HAND. YOU TWO NEED TO GET IN THERE AND SAVE JONES!
CATCH YA ON THE NEXT ROOF, DAREDEVILS!

WE REALLY HIT THE KILLER-NINJA JACKPOT, HUH, BRO?
REMEMBER, SPIDEY. EVIL MAGIC NINJA ARE MORE AFRAID OF YOU THAN YOU ARE OF THEM.
THWIP
THWIP
WHZZZZZT
YOU'RE GONNA BRING THE WHOLE BUILDING DOWN, FRANK!
KRASSH
AS LONG AS IT'S ON TOP OF THIS SCUM, I'LL SLEEP JUST FINE TONIGHT.
BUDDA BUDDA BUDDA
LET'S USE OUR WORDS, FRANK!
I GOT TWO: F--
USE BETTER WORDS!
THWIP
HFFFT!

JUST UP AHEAD--I SEE HIM!
THUNK
HOLD TIGHT, RICK. WE'LL HAVE YOU OUTTA HERE IN NO TIME!
THWACK
STEP RIGHT UP FOR A BUY-ONE-GET-ONE, WEB SPECIAL!
THWIP
THWIP
Y'ALL'S LUCKY DAY!
THWIP
WA-WHURRL
LET'S SHOW 'EM WHAT IT CAN DO!
SPIDEYS SHOOT!
KRASH
SPIDEYS SCORE!

WHAT? SPIDER-MAN?
RICK!
ARE YOU OKAY--?
GET BACK! DON'T TOUCH ME!
THAT'S CERTAINLY A WAY TO SAY THANKS FOR THE HELP.
DON'T NEED A SPIDEY-SENSE TO KNOW SOMETHING'S WRONG. I'VE MET RICK A FEW TIMES.
AND, BUDDY, YOU'RE NOT RICK JONES.
YOU'VE SEEN THROUGH OUR RUSE.
GLZZZ-TCH
BUT YOU'RE STILL TOO LATE!
SPIDER-SENSE!
THOOOM
I FEEL IT! ABOVE!
YOU WOULDN'T HAPPEN TO HAVE AN EXTRA VIBRANIUM SUIT, WOULD YA?
'FRAID NOT.
THOOOOM

To Be Continued -- At Your Table!

/1/ WELCOME TO MAYHEM

Welcome to *Spider-Man—MidtownMayhem*: This adventure for the *Marvel Multiverse Role-Playing Game* is meant for four to six heroes of Ranks 2 to 4.

This is an entirely original adventure based on the mainline Marvel Comics universe (Earth-616), and it features a few deep cuts into that world's history. However, you don't have to know any of that to play in or run this adventure.

NARRATORS ONLY

Like most adventures, this one is meant for the Narrator's eyes only. If you're not planning to run this adventure at some point—or, especially, if you're planning to play through it as a hero—stop reading right now!

No one's going to come to your house and rip this adventure out of your hands, of course. Instead, we're relying on your good nature to help you avoid any spoilers you are sure to come across within these pages if you keep reading.

If you really want to read this adventure from start to finish, you can do so *after* you've played through it. But if you're playing in an ongoing game with the same characters, be sure to check with your Narrator first to be sure that you won't ruin any future plans they might have. Otherwise, have at it.

Then. Not now.

So stop already.

Thanks.

WHAT YOU NEED

To play this adventure, you need the following things at hand:

- **Rules:** The *Marvel Multiverse Role-Playing Game Core Rulebook*. If you don't have that yet, you can check out the *Quick-Start Rules* at **Marvel.com/rpg**. Although those rules can get you started, they don't quite have everything you need to play through the whole adventure.
- **Dice:** A single set of three six-sided dice is enough in a pinch, but a separate set for each player (including the Narrator) works best. One die in each set should be a different color from the others so you can know it's the Marvel die.
- **Character Profiles:** You can use the ones in the back of this book and transfer the details to character sheets.
- **Pencils and Scrap Paper:** Use these to help keep track of things like Health and Focus points, plus any other details.
- **Maps and Figures:** You can play the game in the players' collective imaginations ("Theater of the Mind" style), but if you're not doing that, battlemats and miniatures or markers for each of the characters in the game can help.
- **Venue:** Find a good place to play, either in person or using a virtual tabletop like Roll20. (If you play online, you might not need physical dice, sheets, pencils, paper or miniatures.)
- **Players:** Not counting you (the Narrator), you should have two to six other players join in the fun.

MARVEL EXPERTISE

You do *not* need to be an expert in all things Marvel to be able to run this adventure. Everything you need to know is contained in this book.

However, players often come up with all sorts of questions—so many that there's no way to fit them all even in an entire encyclopedia. If there's anything else you need to figure out on the fly, you have two easy options:

- You can look up the answer, either in a book or online. That has the advantage of fitting in directly with the long and storied history of Marvel Comics, going back to 1939.
- You can make up an answer on your own. Although that might not always jibe with the official answer, your game takes place in its own universe in the Marvel Multiverse. Details can differ. In fact, those differences help make your universe stand on its own.

Either way, don't sweat it too much. This isn't a game in which the players should be playing gotcha over various bits of Marvel trivia. That can be a lot of fun on its own, but the *Marvel Multiverse Role-Playing Game* is about playing through your own stories instead.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Spider-Man — Midtown Mayhem features a single-issue adventure for a Narrator and a group of up to six players taking on the roles of characters from Rank 2 to 4. As the Narrator, you should read through it before you start to play, if only to familiarize yourself with what's to come.

Make sure you understand not just what the heroes are supposed to be doing but also what the villains are doing at each step and why they're doing it. That way, when the heroes do something unexpected—as they often do—you should have a good handle on everything to come up with the perfect response to even the wildest ideas.

The book is broken down into a number of chapters that happen in order. Each chapter is devoted to a certain part of the adventure that can be run as a distinct section on its own. The end of each chapter is a good time to take a break in the game as well.

Art by Steve McNiven, Mark Morales & Marte Gracia

THE CHARACTERS

This adventure is specifically designed for the players to take on the roles of the five characters who appear in the opening comic:

- Daredevil (Elektra Natchios)
- Daredevil (Matt Murdock)
- Punisher (Frank Castle)
- Spider-Man (Miles Morales)
- Spider-Man (Peter Parker)

Although the Punisher is clearly not a hero and does not have the Heroic tag, the adventure refers to the players' characters collectively as *heroes* for the sake of convenience.

In that same spirit, the players do not have to play those five characters. They can use other published profiles if they like, or they can create and use entirely original characters of their own, keeping in mind that they should be Rank 2, Rank 3 or Rank 4.

If possible, have the players send copies of their characters to you ahead of time. That gives you the chance to integrate those characters more tightly into the story if you like. You don't *need* to do this, but it can help make the game feel more important to those characters and—by extension—to their players too. It can also help you anticipate ways that characters might break or avoid certain parts of the adventure with their powers, and it gives you time to come up with solutions to such things.

The only existing character that might disturb the adventure if one of the players insisted on playing him would be the Hulk (Bruce Banner), who is an opponent in the opening fight. However, since the players are limited to characters who are at most Rank 4, that isn't likely to be an issue.

As for the other characters who appear in the adventure, you can find profiles for each of them in the back of this book.

If you don't have enough players, you can have some of the heroes listed above join the heroes' team under your control. Your first choices for that should be Spider-Man (Peter Parker) and the Punisher. Feel free to add others if need be.

THE PLOT

As you can read in the opening comic, someone is attempting to lure the Hulk to Manhattan. In a normal story, you'd have to read all the way through it to figure out what's going on, but since you're running this story for other players, you need to know the scoop.

Here's a summary. Spoilers galore.

- **Chapter 1:** You're reading this right now.
- **Chapter 2:** The Hand tricks the Hulk into coming to Manhattan by creating a video of an impostor Rick Jones being held hostage. They do this as part of an attempt to get a DNA sample from the big green guy. They don't care how much damage he causes because they set it all up inside a warehouse owned by Tombstone, and they're happy to see that get destroyed. The Spider-Men, Punisher and the Daredevils (or your homemade heroes) interrupt the scheme.
- **Chapter 3:** After the battle, Tombstone arrives and claims not to know anything about what's going on. He doesn't like the Hand at all, and he believes someone has taken over a local branch of the Hand in an effort to usurp his business as the crime lord of Manhattan. The heroes have to figure out where the Hand is hiding. It turns out they've been attacking other powered people recently too, so the heroes can find lots of leads with a bit of digging.
- **Chapter 4:** All signs point toward Shadowland, the former headquarters of the Hand back when Daredevil (Matt Murdock) led the organization for a while. The building was a Japanese pagoda in the middle of Hell's Kitchen, but Spider-Man destroyed it when Doctor Otto Octavius had taken over Peter Parker's body. The heroes have to find their way through or around the rubble into the dungeons beneath the place.
- **Chapter 5:** The heroes discover that the Jackal has created his own branch of the Hand by cloning a single Hand ninja over and over. He's also trying to collect DNA samples from super-powered people so he can clone and control them as part of his Hand gang. He hasn't gotten too far, as even force-grown clones require time. However, he did get access to a sample of the Hulk's corpse from back when Hawkeye (Clint Barton) killed him and the Hand temporarily resurrected him. A Bruce Banner clone has secretly been one of the Hand ninja all along, and when the heroes attack the Jackal, the Hand-Hulk reveals himself and tries to kill the heroes.
- **Chapter 6:** Once the dust settles, this chapter helps you wrap up the adventure—or lead the heroes toward more adventures to come.

HANDY HISTORY

The story in this book is tied into stories told in Marvel comics. The players don't need to know any of this. Technically, you don't either. You can run this whole adventure without reading any comics at all.

However, if you're curious about the details, here's a quick summary.

The Hand

The Hand is a shadowy criminal organization based in Japan that goes back hundreds of years. Most of the members are ninja, and many of them are part of a cult that worships an ancient demon known as the Beast. However, the organization is made up of several different factions or clans that sometimes have conflicting interests. The Snakeroot clan, for instance, promotes the worship of the Beast and seeks to have him brought to the real world.

In the modern day, the Hand has often allied with other criminal groups. Under the leadership of Gorgon (Tomi Shishido), they joined with Hydra for a while, and when they came to New York City, they often worked with the Kingpin (Wilson Fisk).

Both Daredevils have long histories with the Hand. Elektra Natchios was originally part of a rival ninja clan called the Chaste, which was led by Stick, the man who trained both her and Matt Murdock. Spider-Man (Peter Parker) and the Punisher have both clashed with the Hand many times. Outside of this story's heroes, Psylocke (Kwannon) and Wolverine (Logan) have often been embroiled with the Hand as well.

Someone posing as Elektra served as the leader of the Hand for a while, but during the Secret Invasion storyline, she was revealed to be a Skrull impostor.

Shadowland

At one point, the Hand recruited Daredevil (Matt Murdock) to unite and lead the organization. He refused at first but eventually relented under pressure, hoping that he could use the Hand to do some good rather than harm. For a while, this worked as he planned, stopping a great deal of crime and corruption in New York City, although he struggled to keep the ninja from using increasingly brutal force to meet his ends.

As part of this, Daredevil set up the Hand's American headquarters in a Japanese-style pagoda built in the heart of Hell's Kitchen. He held court in a throne room in the tower that topped the pagoda, and he kept prisoners in cells in a large dungeon set up in the sewers that ran beneath the building. He called this fortress Shadowland.

One night, after Bullseye escaped from prison, he went to Shadowland to call Daredevil out for a battle. Daredevil and his Hand ninja chased Bullseye down, and Daredevil broke both of Bullseye's arms and then stabbed him, killing him.

This was all part of a plot by the Snakeroot clan to drive Daredevil to willingly commit murder, and once he did, the Beast possessed him. With the help of several heroes, Elektra and Iron Fist (Danny Rand) eventually exorcised the Beast out of Daredevil.

Afterward, the Kingpin took control of the Hand and continued to use Shadowland as the group's headquarters. This lasted until a dying Doctor Octopus took control of the body of his enemy, Spider-Man (Peter Parker).

As the Superior Spider-Man, Doctor Octopus assembled a team of henchmen known as Spiderlings to help him fight crime. They attacked the building with giant, pilotable Spider-Bots called Arachnaughts, defeated the Hand and reduced Shadowland to rubble. The Kingpin faked his death to get away, leaving the Hand leaderless once more.

The Fist and the Beast

In recent times, the Archpriestess of the demon known as the Beast attempted to bring him back into the world again. She chose the Punisher (Frank Castle) as the person the Beast should possess, and she promised to return his long-dead wife and children to him if he accepted the position as the High Slayer of the Hand, known as the Fist of the Beast. This wound up pitting him against Ares, the god of war, whom he killed.

The Daredevils stood against the Punisher, re-forming an ancient rival clan of ninja known as the Fist by recruiting criminals to be trained at their island stronghold. They even married, becoming the king and queen of the Fist, unified against the burgeoning Hand.

With the help of the Avengers, the Punisher eventually rebelled against the control of the Archpriestess and the Beast, who never managed to bring back his kids. Once he was freed, his resurrected wife immediately left him.

The Avengers also intervened against the Daredevils, and the Fist broke apart soon after. Murdock forced Natchios to kill him so he could rescue the souls of Foggy Nelson and Stick.

Both the Punisher and the Daredevils have returned to fighting crime in the streets of New York, much the way they did in their early days. Despite the horrors they inflicted upon each other during their recent encounters with the Hand, they do their best to put all that behind them.

The adventure in this book might bring some of those old struggles back up. However, the Beast is not involved in this story, and despite appearances, very little of the Hand is either. The Jackal is simply using all that history as cover for his own plans.

GETTING THE HEROES INVOLVED

If the players use the heroes in the comic, getting them involved is as simple as following along with that story. If you'd like, you can have the heroes play through the opening scenes as well, replicating some of what happens in the comic.

Otherwise, you can hand the comic to the players—or read it aloud to them—and then launch straight into the game. Just roll for initiative the moment the Hulk shows up.

If the players have different heroes, getting them involved might require a bit more work, but hopefully not too much.

If the heroes live in New York City, they can enter the story the same way the Spider-Men do. They can read news reports about the Hulk being lured to Manhattan and then see the green beacon light up the sky.

If the heroes are from elsewhere, perhaps they're visiting the Big Apple at the moment. It is, after all, the greatest city in the world, and all sorts of things might draw them there. For instance:

- A vacation
- A separate adventure that ends there
- Visiting family or friends
- Seeing a Broadway show
- Checking out the museums
- A comic book convention

Alternatively, some of the characters in the comic might have asked the heroes to cover for them by protecting their regular stomping grounds while they're out of town. This can help tie original heroes more tightly into the Marvel Multiverse by making them feel like they're part of its fabric by knowing established heroes and interacting with them.

In this way, you could explain why, for instance, the Daredevils aren't around to help with an adventure that takes place mostly in Hell's Kitchen. They're out of town—maybe dealing with a different branch of the Hand—and need the heroes to handle things in their backyard while they're gone.

DEALING WITH TEAM CONFLICT

If the players decide to play the characters from the comic, astute Marvel fans might realize that those people often don't work together nicely. In her earlier days, Elektra Natchios was an assassin who worked for the Hand, and this was a huge source of tension between her and her longtime friend Matt Murdock. It wasn't until recently that she also took on the codename Daredevil and committed to avoiding killing people—even those who she thought deserved it—unless absolutely necessary.

However, the Punisher has not had any such revelation. He is still an unrepentant killer. The fact that he targets criminals rather than innocent people doesn't mean that his hands are clean. They're just covered in the blood of the guilty.

This is not something that most heroes—characters with the Heroic tag—are willing to tolerate. They have a moral issue with murder, and they spend much of their time trying to save people from being hurt or killed. They aren't willing to stand by and watch someone kill other people, no matter what crimes those people might have committed.

Despite that, many heroes have been known to work alongside such antiheroes as the Punisher. There are a few ways to help this happen in your game.

To make things work, the heroes and the antiheroes must be willing to put aside their philosophical differences for the length of the story. Although they might never be friends and are likely reluctant to work together, the villains they're all trying to beat or the people they're all trying to protect make it worth calling a temporary truce.

Because of this, the antiheroes should be willing to give up their murderous ways for the length of the adventure. To reciprocate, the heroes should agree not to accost the antiheroes for their past crimes for the duration as well. Once the greater problem has been dealt with, all bets are off, but until then, the characters must work together.

Good players work toward such agreements for the sake of the game. Rather than bog down the story by having their characters bicker endlessly, they look for common ground on which they can forge necessary bonds.

A bit of banter and conflict can be engaging and entertaining and add a lot of flavor to a game. However, most Marvel stories are about the ways heroes rise to the occasion rather than how they bring each other down. Focus on making the arrangement work—at least for as long as it needs to—before letting such differences drive the characters apart.

Toward the end of the adventure, these clashes can ramp up tensions. When the characters realize they're about to accomplish their shared goals, their need to play nice with each other may end as well. The question about who will break their agreement first can color the final scenes, lending uncertainty to how the story winds up. Some characters might be willing to risk the partnership to do what they feel they must, and that can add all sorts of interesting wrinkles to the aftermath.

But the characters have to get to that part first.

Art by SKAN

/2/ BRAND-NEW SMASH

The first part of the story opens just as the comic book ends. If you want to start there, you can have the players read the comic and then skip to "Hulk Smash(es In)" on page 19.

Alternatively, you can play out the scenes depicted in the comic as well if you like, especially if the players haven't read the comic. Either way, you should read this whole chapter so you know everything about what's going on.

THE PROLOGUE

In the weeks leading up to the events in the comic, the Jackal's branch of the Hand—he calls them his Claw clan—has been quietly attacking various super-powered people and taking samples of their DNA. He hopes to use this to clone them and control them, much like he controls his single member of the Hand. In this way, he plans to assemble a team of super-powered ninja he can use to destroy Tombstone and his gang and take over as the new kingpin of crime in New York City.

The ninja take great pains to not be seen and to leave as little evidence of their activities as possible. Sometimes, they simply prowl through crime scenes, hoping to find splashes of blood, tufts of hair or even a knocked-free tooth. They've even tried raiding police department evidence lockers, but the quality of the samples found there has been low.

Since fresher samples are better, the ninja often lie in wait and attack their chosen victims whenever the opportunity arises. On some nights, they hang out near the Bar With No Name—a notorious super-villain tavern—and follow the patrons when they leave. This lets them take down drunken villains fast, often before the targets even know what's happening.

To keep from attracting too much attention, the ninja try to leave their targets alive. It would be easy to kill the people they've knocked unconscious, but they don't want to spark the kind of investigation that a bunch of villains winding up dead would cause. However, if they do have to kill someone, they like to shoot the victim in an effort to make it look like the handiwork of the Punisher.

The Dead Hulk

The Jackal started this program after the ninja he cloned told him of the time the Hand brought the Hulk back to life after Hawkeye (Clint Barton) killed Bruce Banner. They brought the corpse to Japan and used their magic to bring Banner back to life. However, the remains of the Avengers Unity Division interrupted the ceremony, and instead of being brought back with a purpose, the Hulk returned to life as a mindless beast.

The Avengers managed to contain the Hulk long enough for Doctor Voodoo (Jericho Drumm) to remove the curse the Hand's ceremony had inflicted upon Banner. With that, the man passed away again, and the Avengers secured his remains.

With the help of the cloned ninja, the Jackal recovered Banner's original coffin and retrieved some DNA samples from it. He created a clone from this material, although it was the same kind of mindless brute that the Hand had tried to control, one who was markedly weaker than the original.

A Live Hulk

Frustrated with those results, the Jackal set his sights on obtaining a DNA sample from the current Hulk, who'd now returned from death several times. To that end, he dressed up one of his cloned ninja as Rick Jones and used a deep face device to make a live video of the man looking and sounding like the actual Jones.

The Jackal had his ninja broadcast the video from an anonymous feed, insisting that the Hulk come to Manhattan to rescue Jones before they were forced to kill him. The Jackal then monitored news reports to follow the Hulk's progress toward New York, and once the Hulk got close enough, the Jackal ordered the ninja to light the green spotlight that showed the Hulk where to go.

The Jackal was all too aware that countless super heroes call Manhattan home. He knew that if he just gave the Hulk an address at which they could meet, other heroes would probably show up instead. He hoped that his tricks would keep the number of heroes who showed up to a minimum, and it seems to have worked.

Only your game's heroes got there before the Hulk, and now they have to deal with him—and with all the Hand ninja too.

BEFORE THE HULK

As noted earlier, you could have the players read the comic in the front of this book and then throw the heroes straight into the action.

If you like, however, you can start the game before the events in the comic. This works better if the players haven't read the comic yet. If they have, you can still play through this portion. Just encourage the players to act as if their characters have no idea what's going on. In addition, you can change some of the details to keep them on their toes.

The Video

The video premieres online at 8 p.m. Eastern Time. Read or paraphrase the following aloud to the players:

The video shows a man sitting in a chair in a darkened room, a single light bulb hanging overhead, casting his face in shadow. A voice speaks from somewhere in the darkness. *"Bruce Banner, also known as the Hulk. You have caused untold agony to millions of people with your uncontrollable rages that have laid waste to entire cities and harmed thousands of souls.*

"Now it is time for you to share in their pain. To pay for what you've done.

"We're going to start with one of your oldest friends: Rick Jones. He was there at the start of the Hulk. Now he's going to be there at the end. Come face us in Manhattan if you dare. Otherwise, after we kill him, we'll be forced to find someone else you might care about."

A hand in a red glove reaches out of the darkness to grab Jones by the hair and haul his face into the light. His nose is broken, and he's a blood-soaked mess.

"Don't do it, big guy!" Jones growls as he struggles against his bonds, but they keep him held tight. *"It's a trap!"*

The gloved hand turns into a fist and smashes Jones in the face.

"Of course it is," the disembodied voice says. *"But if you don't smash your way into it, Jones dies.*

"You have until midnight tonight."

The video ends there.

The Evacuation

The New York City mayor's office issues a green alert. This system was invented to let the public know when an impending superhuman battle was imminent. It was originally instituted after the event known as World War Hulk and uses the color green as a reminder of that.

Green also means *go*, as in: leave town, now, if you can. If not, you are expected to shelter in place, ideally in a basement or at least in a room on a lower floor with no windows. (These are the same kinds of directions given out during tornado warnings.)

Many New Yorkers have become jaded to the green alert over the years. Instead of leaping into action (or at least safety), they get on the internet to see if the threat is as real and immediate as the warning suggests. If not, they kick back and relax, keeping an eye on reports as they come in, ready to dive into shelter the moment things change.

In this circumstance, though, the people of Manhattan have a well-justified reason to fear a visit from an angry Hulk. The fact that the video isn't any more specific than telling the Hulk to come to the borough means that he might wind up anywhere on the island.

Many people left town immediately, by any means they had available. The trains, subways, bridges and tunnels all clogged with traffic worse than that on any holiday. And once those folks escaped Manhattan, they didn't stop. They all know that super-powered battles have a habit of spilling over the banks of the East River and the Hudson River, and most people didn't see the point of hauling up short to watch the fight if it would keep them at risk.

Of course, not everyone in Manhattan is able to leave. Many people have no personal means of transportation and are not willing to brave the subway, buses or trains. Some daring souls set out to walk across the bridges, but those have been damaged enough times in the past that few people are ready to risk it on foot.

The police and fire departments do their best to keep the streets clear. They have their hands full dealing with the inevitable accidents and conflicts that happen during such evacuations, and they focus on the things they can help with. The things under their control.

Things very much unlike the Hulk.

The Looting

Some people see any crisis not as a disaster but as an opportunity. In particular, the criminals of Manhattan know that the best time to rob places is when no one is home. It's even better when a good part of the city is empty.

Lots of super villains are sure to take advantage of the situation, hoping to make a quick and easy score while all eyes are on the Hulk's approach. The comic shows the Spider-Men stopping the Looter (who's doing his best to live up to his codename) and the Bumbler (who's doing much the same), but those are just two of the ambitious crooks they fight that night.

Feel free to throw a number of different criminals in the heroes' path. This can be a great way to get the players warmed up for the adventure, especially if they're new to the game and the heroes haven't been in any fights yet.

To start with, the heroes can encounter a group of Tombstone's henchmen (see the profile in the back of this book). Use one henchman for each hero. They shouldn't be much of a challenge, but that's the point. Most of the crooks in the nearly empty streets of Manhattan tonight aren't the smartest or toughest people around. They're simply opportunists looking for an easy score.

Alternatively, you can use profiles from the *Core Rulebook*, including the A.I.M. agent and the Hydra agent. If you have the *Spider-Verse Expansion*, you can use the street punk henchman profile from that book.

You could even throw in a group of Hand ninja who aren't associated with the Jackal. That might serve as a red herring for the heroes, but perhaps those ninja are here to figure out why the Hand is getting reports of Hand ninja in New York City that—as far as they know—aren't part of the organization.

If the heroes make quick work of those Rank 1 villains, feel free to throw some Rank 2 villains at them next. For instance, you could have them face off against a coven of vampires out to feed on this strange night. Use the vampire profile in the *Core Rulebook*.

In any case, these villains don't have any idea what's going on with the Hulk, Rick Jones or anyone else involved in the main plot. They're just part of the fabric of the criminal nightlife in Marvel's Manhattan. The heroes shouldn't spend too much time dealing with them.

Don't knock the heroes around too much. They still have a long night ahead of them.

THE WAREHOUSE

When you're ready to move the action along, the Jackal's ninja activate the green spotlight, as seen in the comic. They do this only when news reports place the Hulk in the area, searching for whoever is supposedly holding Rick Jones hostage.

The Jackal knows that lighting the beacon is sure to bring all sorts of people to investigate, including the New York Police Department. For that reason, he holds off until what he hopes is the last moment. Ideally, the Hulk would be leaping overhead, and the beacon would shine on him the instant it turns on. The Jackal isn't that lucky though.

Instead, when the beacon lights up, the heroes have only minutes until the Hulk arrives. It's up to you to decide how close they might be to the warehouse in which the Jackal's ninja and the fake Rick Jones are waiting.

If you want to follow the events in the comic, the heroes should have just enough time to reach the warehouse and slip inside to investigate before the Hulk arrives. If you need them to meet up with other heroes under your control, this is the right time to make that happen. In any case, don't give the team enough time to do much else beforehand.

The warehouse sits near the Hudson River, north of Hell's Kitchen. This area is firmly under the control of Tombstone, who—at the moment—runs most of the organized crime in Manhattan. In fact, he owns this warehouse and often uses it to smuggle things in and out of the city, including weapons, drugs and even people. He does so under the cover of a legitimate business known as Lincoln Import-Export Incorporated—or L.I.E., Inc.

The Jackal knows this, which is why he decided to host this operation here rather than near his own headquarters. He wants not only to secure some of the Hulk's DNA, but also to cause chaos for Tombstone by creating a crime scene that gives the NYPD an excuse to poke around the warehouse.

Outside the Warehouse

The Jackal wants the Hulk to enter the warehouse and try to rescue his friend, but the Hand have orders to stop anyone else from going in before the Hulk arrives. The ninja know that the beacon is bound to attract more than just the Hulk. They are expecting interlopers and are prepared for them.

It's dark when the heroes arrive, and the ninja are hidden. Spotting them requires Vigilance vs. TN 11 action checks, with trouble due to the darkness.

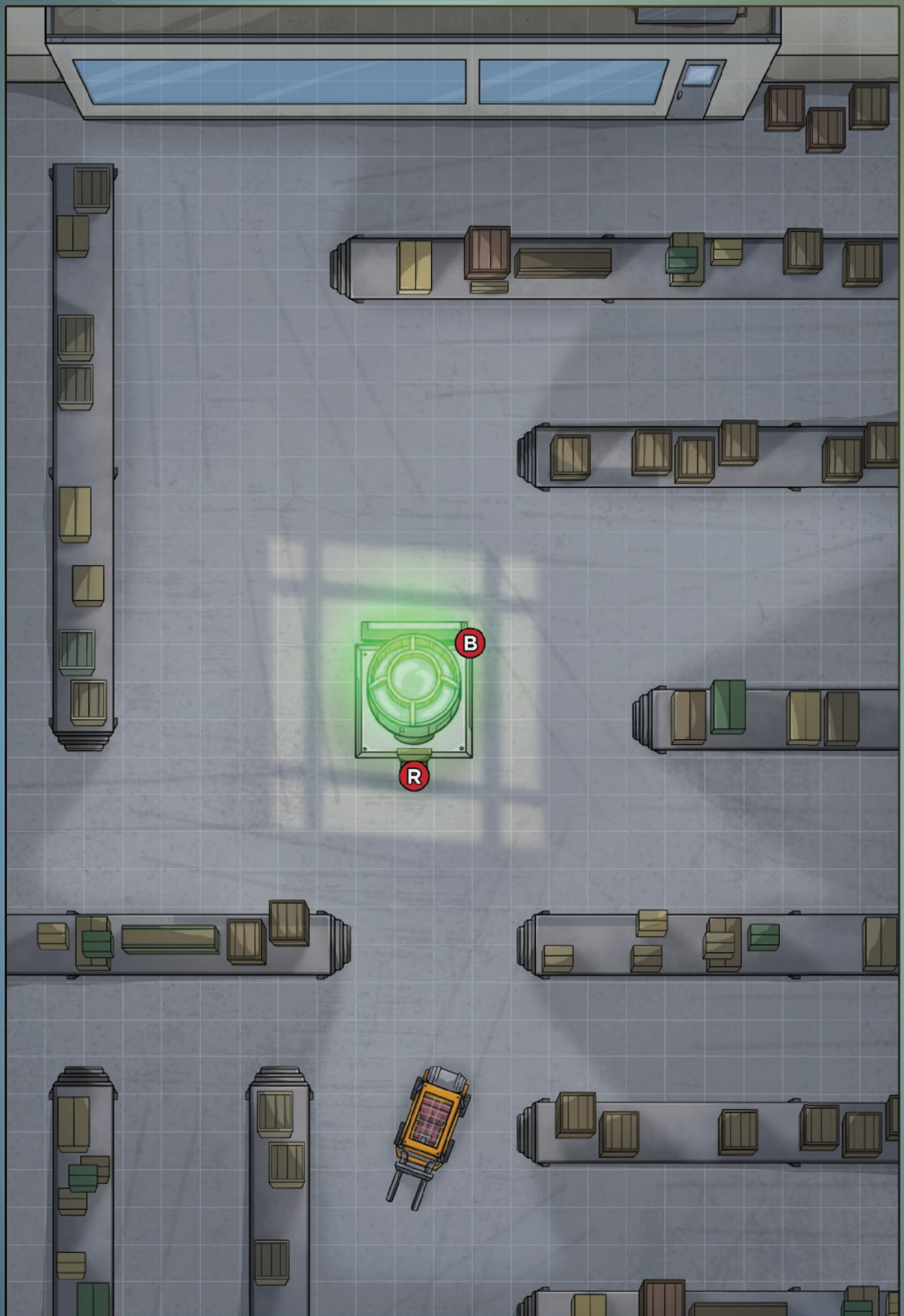
If the heroes approach the warehouse, the Hand attacks. There are four Hand ninja outside for each hero, and each is armed with a bow and arrow and a sword.

During the first round of combat, the ninja attack normally. After that, they realize they are no match for the heroes, so most of them use help actions to give their fellow ninja edges against the heroes, hoping they can draw blood—or at least slow the heroes down long enough to give the Hulk time to arrive.

These Hand ninja are particularly reckless, not caring about their own lives, which they don't consider real. They are all too happy to sacrifice themselves for their creator, the Jackal.

If the heroes overcome or avoid the ninja, there are several easy ways to get into the warehouse. None of the doors or windows are locked, as the ninja have been using them to get in and out of the building. On top of that, the skylight in the middle of the roof is wide open so the beacon can shine through it unhindered.

The Hand don't want to keep the heroes out permanently—just long enough for the Hulk to arrive. Then they want to be able to get out of there as fast as they can.



B. Beacon
R. Rick Jones

ONE SQUARE EQUALS 5FT.

WAREHOUSE

Art by Irene Strychalski & Ian Herring

Smoke and Dust

Many Hand ninja have a spell cast on them that causes them to dissolve into smoke when they are killed, to remove evidence that they were there. This is often true of the members of the Snakeroot clan or others who have been brought back to life under the control of the Hand.

For all his strengths, the Jackal doesn't have magical powers. However, his clones turn to dust when killed, and many people would have a hard time telling the difference between the two effects.

If a hero has previously seen a Hand ninja die and dissolve and witnesses one of the clones turn to dust, they can make a non-combat Logic vs. TN 12 action check to notice that the effect is different. This applies to the Daredevils and the Punisher.

If a hero has seen a clone made by the Jackal die and turn to dust, they can make a similar check to notice that the effect is similar. This applies to Spider-Man (Peter Parker).

Ninja Clones

The heroes might not recognize that the ninja are all clones for a while, and that's fine. Let them figure it out in their own good time.

If the heroes remove the mask of a ninja, they can see the face of the man. If they do so to another ninja, have them make a Vigilance vs. TN 10 check to see if they recognize that the men are identical.

The Punisher (and any antiheroes like him) aren't likely to leave a ninja alive long enough to get a look at one of their faces before they die. While Natchios used to kill Hand ninja regularly, she's now committed to doing her best to avoid murder.

Ninja who are simply knocked out and not killed can easily be unmasked. However, the Jackal equipped each of the ninja clones with a hollow tooth that contains cyanide. If a ninja is captured and conscious, they crack the tooth and swallow the poison, dying within a single round and turning to dust the next.

Inside the Warehouse

See the map (page 17) of how the main part of the warehouse is laid out. The ceiling in this area is 30 feet (6 spaces) high, and the walls have plenty of handholds for climbing them.

There are few windows into the main part of the warehouse, although skylights in the roof can be levered open from below or above. One such skylight in the middle of the roof is thrown all the way open so the beacon can shine through it unhindered.

The warehouse is filled with tall shelves that reach nearly to the ceiling. This gives the ninja lots of places to hide as well as narrow areas in which to trap interlopers.

There are lights throughout the place, but most of them are turned off, leaving much of the interior in shadows. The major exceptions are the beacon—which was wheeled into the warehouse for this operation—and a single overhead light that shines down toward the beacon from the ceiling. Scattered light from the edges of the beacon throws sharp shadows throughout the central area.

The center of the main room is open, with plenty of space for trucks to back up for unloading by forklift as well as for the forklifts to turn about. Whatever was in the middle before has been cleared out for the beacon, which is about 5 feet (1 space) around and built like an airport spotlight. It sits there, pointing straight up, its beam spearing through the skylight and into the night sky.

There are just as many ninja inside the warehouse as there were outside: four for each hero. These ninja have orders to stay inside and protect the fake Rick Jones at any cost. The Jackal does not want anyone interfering with his bait before he springs his trap on the Hulk.

The ninja disguised as Rick Jones sits in a chair at the base of the beacon, apparently tied to it. The light from above casts his face into dark green shadows.

He wears a device the Jackal built that looks like a necklace, and it's concealed beneath his collar. It's called a *deep face*, and it grants the user the Disguise power for their head. In this case, he uses it to resemble Rick Jones. The fake Jones also wears blue jeans and a T-shirt that has the words "Gamma Free for 0 Days" emblazoned across it.

Note that the deep face necklace can only take 5 points of Health damage before being completely destroyed.

Rescuing "Rick"

The heroes can decide what to do once they reach the warehouse, but rescuing the hostage being held in front of the beacon seems like the obvious priority. Because of that, it might also seem like a trap—which it is! Just not one that's meant for the heroes.

Any attempts to reach Jones' mind are doomed to fail. If the heroes figure this out, this should be enough to make them suspicious. However, they might think it's something the ninja did to keep Jones from communicating with anyone who might want to rescue him.

The heroes likely have to jump in and get their hands on Jones to figure out what's going on. Once they do, they can make an Ego vs. TN 11 action check to realize that the person tied to the chair is not Jones. If a hero has met Jones before, give them an edge on the check.

If the heroes try to free Jones, he snarls at them to leave him alone. He tells them he doesn't want their help and they should get out of there before the Hulk shows up.

If the heroes think to look for traps when they are within reach of the fake Jones, have them make a Vigilance vs. TN 15 action check. If they succeed, they discover a bomb hidden beneath the man's chair. See the next section for how this works, but if the heroes try to disable it while the fake Jones is conscious, he triggers it. Otherwise, they can disarm it with a Logic vs. TN 13 check.

A moment later, the disguised ninja cocks his head to the side, listening to something. The heroes can make another Vigilance vs. TN 14 action check to see if they hear it too. (Note that characters with Spider-Sense get an edge on this check to perceive danger.) If they do, they detect something whistling through the air like a missile heading straight for them.

Shy Heroes

If the ninja manage to keep the heroes away—or if the heroes decide not to go into the warehouse, as they're sure it's a trap—that's fine. Let them stay outside and wait for things to happen. That's not the way most heroes might handle it, but they get to make their own choices.

However, they miss out on seeing what happens next. Instead, they'll have to piece it together on their own the best they can.

HULK SMASH(ES IN)

If you're skipping from the end of the comic to start the story straight away, you're in the right place. Be sure to read everything before this too though.

There are four Hand ninja inside the warehouse for each hero, plus the fake Rick Jones tied to the chair. These ninja have orders to stay inside the warehouse and protect the fake Jones at any cost.

Making an Entrance

At the most dramatic moment, the Hulk comes hurtling down through the roof of the warehouse to rescue his friend. He falls straight into the green beacon, smashing it to pieces. Anyone within 2 spaces of the beacon must make an Agility vs. TN 12 action check or take dMarvel×2 Health damage. The only exception is the fake Rick Jones, who the Hulk takes care not to injure.

If the fight hasn't already started inside the warehouse, it's time to roll for initiative. As the Narrator, you control not only all of the ninja, but the Hulk as well.

When the Hulk arrives, he believes that anyone he sees in the warehouse is involved in the plot to lure him to New York City to rescue Jones. That includes the heroes. He attacks any of them who are close enough to reach, although he refuses to let them draw him out of the warehouse until he knows Jones is safe.

Meanwhile, the ninja attack the heroes, trying to keep them from interfering with Jones or luring the Hulk away.

As soon as the Hulk doesn't have a hero or ninja within 6 spaces (his Run Speed), he turns to Jones to grab the man and leap away to safety with him. The moment he puts his hands on the

fake Jones, the ninja deactivates the deep face device, exposing the ruse.

The Hulk grabs the man and threatens to smash him if he doesn't say what happened to Rick. But the man just grins and detonates the bomb that's hidden under the chair he's tied to.

Have the fake Jones make an Agility attack with a +10 bonus. The bomb does dMarvel×3 Health damage to anyone affected within 5 spaces.

However, it automatically gets a Fantastic success on anyone holding on to the chair, which means it does twice the damage to the Hulk and the fake Jones. This should be enough to just barely hurt the Hulk, but it also stuns him. Either way, it's automatically fatal for the fake Jones, who turns to dust when he dies, apparently pulverized by the blast.

The explosion also blows out all the windows in the place and sets off the fire-suppression system. Water begins spraying from the sprinklers in the ceiling, causing trouble to all Agility checks inside the building until the system is turned off. The controls for this system are in the maintenance closet. Alternatively, the fire department can turn off the water supply from outside the building.

After the Blast

Any ninja still active move toward the Hulk and use an action to take a DNA sample from him—likely a bit of blood or even skin. They then flee the area as fast as they can, trying to escape with their prize. If they can, they climb to the rooftops and leap from building to building until they disappear into the night.

It's entirely possible that the Jackal's plan fails. The heroes might subdue all the ninja or stop them from getting away. If so, the ninja may kill themselves to avoid capture.

Alternatively, the heroes might have too much on their hands to worry about the ninja. Or you can decide that there were more ninja in the warehouse than the ones guarding the fake Jones, and these others manage to get away with the DNA.

When the Hulk recovers from being stunned, he is furious. He immediately attacks anyone next to him, shouting about how they either killed Rick or let Rick get killed. He hates them all.

If the Hulk gets his hands on anyone, he pounds them into unconsciousness. He keeps doing this until he is the only one still in the building or the heroes find some way to calm him down. They can try to reason with him or soothe him, but any attempts to do so have trouble when he's in such a state of rage.

If the Hulk knows and trusts a hero, that hero has an edge on any such efforts, although this only cancels out the trouble that they have from the Hulk's rage.

If the Hulk finds himself alone, he returns to Jones' corpse, only to find a pile of dust. It's then that he knows for sure that this isn't his friend. He kicks the dust aside and says, "This why Hulk should not have friends."

If the heroes somehow manage to calm the Hulk down, he still insists on checking for Jones' body, finding the dust and saying the same thing.

Either way, the Hulk doesn't stick around. He's angry about being fooled, and he just wants to be left alone. He leaps out through the warehouse's roof, soaring off into the darkness. If the heroes pursue, he insists that he just wants to get away. If they force the issue, he attacks them and tries to beat them unconscious to keep them from chasing him.

Art by Ron Lim, Dan Panosian, Greg Adams, Mitch Breitweiser & Chris Sotomayor

/3/ FIND THE HAND

Once the Hulk escapes, the heroes have to deal with the aftermath. A big part of that is trying to figure out why the Hand lured the Hulk into a trap and what they hoped to get out of it. To find those answers, the heroes must locate the Hand's headquarters.

THE HEROES AND THE LAW

At the moment, Luke Cage is the mayor of New York City, having taken over the position from Kingpin (Wilson Fisk), who passed the Anti-Vigilante Act, an ordinance outlawing vigilantes in the city. Cage has finally overturned the law. Now that a former vigilante is the mayor, the police and prosecutors have lost much of their appetite for persecuting vigilantes.

If the heroes are established super heroes with solid reputations, the police are likely to let them be. The NYPD knows about the Spider-Men and the Daredevils, for instance, and is not likely to attempt to arrest them for trying to help out.

The Punisher, on the other hand, is a known killer with plenty of warrants out for his arrest. Because he sticks to killing hardened criminals, many police officers are willing to look the other way rather than chase him down, and he knows better than to push that. It only takes one passionate cop to start a problem that can quickly turn into a firefight, and the Punisher is firmly against harming good police officers. (Corrupt ones, though, are a different story.)

New Faces

If the heroes are new or unknown characters, the NYPD might mistake them for criminals or even believe that they are responsible for the video that lured the Hulk to the city. How the heroes deal with this is up to them.

Most police officers know better than to pick a fight with super-powered people who aren't actively threatening innocents. The costumes mark them as someone to handle with extra care. This is especially true if the police don't recognize the costume, as it means they have no idea what that person might be capable of doing.

If the heroes are friendly to the officers and don't actively break any laws, the police are liable to leave well enough alone. If the heroes are hostile or do something clearly illegal in front of the officers, however, they feel compelled to act.

If the officers believe the heroes are too powerful to handle on their own—even with a dozen officers on their side—they might not accost them directly, especially if no one is in imminent danger. Instead, they might pull back and call for super-powered help. The NYPD has seen it all before, and they want to be able to go home at the end of their shift.

However, if the heroes appear to be threatening or otherwise endangering civilians, the officers confront them and order them to stop. If the heroes refuse, the officers attack them with pistols or—if they're part of a SWAT team—rifles.

KEEPING THE HEROES INVOLVED

Once the Hulk is gone and the immediate threat is over, the heroes might decide that they don't need to stick around. After all, if they only wanted to rescue Rick Jones, they failed badly at that, and the Hulk managed to escape seemingly without doing any harm to anyone other than the Hand—and whoever owns the warehouse.

For lots of heroes, the mystery about what's really going on behind the scenes is enough to draw them in. It's one thing to stop the Hand, but not knowing what the Hand was trying to do—or who might be behind this particular chapter of the organization—is often enough to encourage the heroes to dig deeper.

If they bail, though, that can make it harder to continue the adventure. It's not terribly heroic for characters to walk away from unanswered questions, but it can happen. There are a few ways you can encourage the heroes to stick around.

If you can help it, don't have the NYPD chase them away. Instead, the cops can gripe at the heroes about making such a big mess but not sticking around to help clean it up. Maybe if they showed some interest in an odd rise of attacks in their community, they could help stop such things before they happened instead of waiting for the Hand to strike again.

You could have someone ask the heroes to help out. This could include a forensic scientist like Carlie Cooper or a reporter like Ben Urich. Or a victim of the Hand's recent assaults might ask for help too.

You know the heroes and their players. Tug at things that matter to them to keep their interest.

IN THE WAKE OF THE HULK

As soon as the fight in the warehouse ends, the NYPD swarms in. The police received reports of the green beacon the Hand lit up to bring the Hulk to them, and rather than rush in, they cordoned off the area to keep anyone else away from the warehouse. Squad cars and temporary barriers block off the surrounding streets, and officers direct traffic away from the area.

The NYPD knows better than to barge into a place where the Hulk is expected to show up shortly. The unofficial policy is to alert the local hero teams like the Avengers and the Fantastic Four and then simply do the best they can to minimize the damage to the surrounding area.

Once the Hulk departs, a SWAT team enters the warehouse immediately to see if there is anyone to arrest or rescue. What they find there depends on how the battle with the Hand and the Hulk went and where the heroes ended up afterward. If there are people who need medical assistance, the SWAT team calls in a waiting ambulance to help—after they declare the place safe.

Any members of the Hand who are unconscious try to escape the moment they revive. If it's clear that they cannot manage that, they kill themselves with their poison capsules and turn to dust. No one else should be in the building other than the heroes, but if they need medical help, they can visit the ambulances outside for aid.

The Damage Done

The next order of business for the police is to shut off the sprinkler system that the bomb set off. This is easy enough to do if they or the heroes can find the controls in the maintenance closet, but the heroes might have other ideas about how to do it faster.

The sprinkler system put out any fires that the bomb might have started. It also ruined much of the crime scene, obliterating any fingerprints and proper DNA samples that the Hand might have left behind. The Hand didn't intend for the sprinkler system to go off, as it also complicated their efforts to procure a sample of the Hulk's DNA.

The water dampened everything in the main part of the warehouse, but the rest of the place is dry. Most of the material on the shelves was packed in cardboard boxes or wooden crates and is not badly damaged.

The same cannot be said for the beacon and the chair to which the Hand impostor was tied. The impostor turned to dust upon his death, and much of those remains have been washed away, leaving only his clothes behind—and the remnants of the deep face device.

Crime Scene Investigators

A team of detectives who specialize in examining crime scenes involving super-powers enters next. This includes Carlie Cooper, a forensic scientist who once dated Peter Parker. Cooper is aware that Parker is Spider-Man and is also a member of a support group called the Lookups, created by Edwin Jarvis (the Avengers' longtime butler) for people who carry the weight of knowing the identities of the super heroes in their lives.

Cooper and her assistants discover most of the details described above. The heroes can help her investigate if they like, but she is only able to find things that they already know about.

Art by Alex Saviuk & Chris Sotomayor

Enter Tombstone

Moments after Cooper and her team enter the building, Tombstone (Lonnie Lincoln) arrives on the scene, along with his lawyer, Michelle Le, who runs interference for him with the police. As the owner of the building, Tombstone has a vested interest in it, and he demands to know what's happened there.

Although most people know that Tombstone is the current head of the New York crime families, Le insists that he is a legitimate businessman and that he should be referred to as "Mister Lincoln" at all times. Le went to law school with Tombstone's daughter, Janice Lincoln, perhaps better known as the new Beetle, who is currently estranged from her father after he tried to kill her to keep her from testifying against him.

Tombstone is concerned that someone dared to break into one of his warehouses and damage it. On top of that, he does not want the attention that an attack like this is bound to bring.

Le informs Cooper that if the police want to investigate the warehouse, they need to produce a warrant, but Cooper laughs her off. This is an active crime scene, and they don't need a warrant to enter. Le argues that the immediate danger is over and informs Cooper that the owner of the building demands that they leave immediately.

If the heroes don't intervene, Le runs Cooper and her team out of the warehouse. Normally, the police might not give in to such demands, but they are all too aware that Tombstone has super-powers and a poor temper.

Cooper doesn't want her people hurt, so she backs off and radios in for a search warrant, which she anticipates having within the hour. Meanwhile, she and the rest of the police keep the building surrounded and maintain a steady watch on the place.

An Offer They Might Not Refuse

While Le deals with the police, Tombstone approaches the heroes and comments about how everyone's always picking on him and ignoring the "real" criminals in town. Rather than wasting time by hassling a tax-paying citizen like him, they should be out there trying to stop the Hand. He'd even be interested in helping them make that happen.

Given the chance, Cooper grudgingly admits that Tombstone has a point. The heroes probably can't do much to help here at the moment, but if they can figure out what the Hand was up to, that might save the city a lot of trouble. After all, anyone who is reckless enough to lure the Hulk to Manhattan might be plotting to do much worse.

Le complains about the heroes poking around the place, potentially planting false evidence on the property. She officially demands that they leave and further suggests that the police arrest them.

The police laugh that off, but Cooper makes it clear to the heroes that their presence is only complicating things. She would rather have them take off. If she gets a chance, she slips them a business card and says they can contact her later.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

At this point, the heroes may have a lot of questions. Some of the things they are likely trying to figure out include:

- Who was behind this? It seems pretty obvious that it was the Hand, but is that true? And if so, which branch of the Hand was responsible? The Snakeroot clan has caused the most trouble for the Punisher and the Daredevils in the past, but they have fought against other parts of the organization as well.
- What do they want? The heroes might not have seen the ninja collect blood or skin from the Hulk. Even if they did, what does it mean? Why would the Hand want a genetic sample from the Hulk?
- Where did they go? The ninja likely have disappeared at this point, but where are they headquartered? Are they here in New York City? Are they teleporting in from Japan or someplace else? Where can the heroes find and confront them?

The players might not have formulated all these questions yet, and you don't have to frame them out. In fact, you shouldn't. Let the players be smart about it and work through the questions and search for clues. It's more rewarding to figure it out on their own rather than have you lead them through everything by the nose.

In that same way, don't offer them guidance unless you need to. They know what just happened. They played through the last chapter, and they likely have all sorts of questions of their own without you hand-feeding them anything.

Keeping Things on Track

All that said, sometimes players get lost in the middle of an investigation. They pick up on things you say that don't mean anything in particular and will lead them to a dead end. They find clues that are just part of the background and infuse them with meaning that is bound to draw them astray.

When that happens, you have a few options.

First, you can downplay the supposed clue and the theories that it spawns. Sometimes all that takes is a subtle shake of the head when the players give you a questioning look. They often take the advice and drop things that aren't going to lead anywhere.

Occasionally, though, they take it as a sign that they're on the right track and you're trying to throw them off. Hopefully, you haven't given them reason to think that in the past. If so, you might have to come straight out and tell the players—hand on your heart—that they're wasting their time.

A more subtle way, though, is to have a trusted character—like Carlie Cooper or Ben Urich—contact the heroes and make it clear to them that they're on the wrong track. They can simply take apart the heroes' theory, or they could even supply a more plausible (and correct) one.

It's okay to let the heroes run down a red herring or two, leading them away from the real sources of trouble. That's a good part of the fun in solving many mysteries. That can pale quickly, though, especially if you have limited time to devote to a gaming session.

Second, you can take whatever wrongheaded clue the heroes are focusing on and integrate it into the story. So what if you didn't think of it yourself or it doesn't appear in this book? If the players came up with something on their own and you can redirect it to work with the story, roll with it!

This has the advantage of making the adventure feel more natural and less forced. You don't need to shove the heroes along any particular track. You've scattered clues that they can follow in whatever order they like, and if they happen to come up with theories that you hadn't planned for, all the better.

You don't have to let them know that though. Don't draw back the curtain to show them what's happening—at least not yet. If you have a debrief with the players after the adventure is finished, that's the time to let them know about what happened behind the scenes. That's also a great time to explain things that they missed or that got ignored or glossed over at certain points.

INVESTIGATION OPTIONS

The heroes have several options for looking for clues about what's going on. They include:

- Speaking with Cooper
- Speaking with Tombstone
- Contacting a reporter for leads
- Contacting Rick Jones
- Questioning local criminals

Each of these options is described in depth below, along with the clues that such encounters can provide.

The heroes might also want to contact connections of their own. If so, feel free to have such people reveal or hint at some of the clues mentioned in this section.

Speaking With Cooper

Art by Paulo Siqueira & Amilton Santos

Carlie Cooper cares about her job and does it well. For that reason, she's not willing to be seen conversing openly with the heroes about an ongoing investigation. If they reach her on her phone, she leaves the warehouse (or other location) to take the call privately.

At the same time, she's been part of the NYPD long enough to know that many crimes they try to solve are beyond the ability of regular people to handle—even those with the power of the law behind them. As such, she is willing to speak off the record with people who might have the ability to do something. She just has to trust them first.

Cooper doesn't allow emotion to enter the picture when it comes to her job, so a hero speaking with her cannot try to convince her with an Ego check. They must try a Logic vs. TN 13 action check instead. If Cooper doesn't know the hero at all, they have trouble on the check.

Cooper already trusts Spider-Man (Peter Parker) and knows him well. He doesn't need to make such a check with her. Conversely, she knows the Punisher's reputation enough for him to have double trouble on the check.

Cooper knows the following details:

- The bomb damaged the Hulk enough to cause him to bleed. The sprinkler system washed away most of that though.
- The Hand ninja bled as well, but they didn't leave any bodies behind—just a number of red ninja outfits, crumpled in piles on the floor. They all contained a strange residue that she is sending to the lab for testing. It seems like dust, but again, the sprinklers soaked everything and washed a lot of the residue away.
- Some of the merchandise inside the warehouse is likely stolen goods, but the NYPD needs to check it against their records to be sure.

Speaking With Tombstone

Tombstone is eager to speak to the heroes. He feels pretty sure they didn't have anything to do with what happened in his warehouse, and he also doesn't trust the police to bring the perpetrators to justice. Michelle Le counsels him not to trust the heroes either, but he ignores her. She sticks around when he speaks with them, ready to call the police the moment any of them appear to threaten her client. Tombstone is canny enough to not confess to any crimes while speaking with the heroes.

He worries that his rivals are out to get him—because they always are. He's not sure, though, if someone hired the Hand to do all this, if the Hand is working on their own or if they're under the direct control of one of his rivals.

He knows the following:

- This is not an isolated situation. He always has people trying to muscle in on his turf, but they're not usually ninja. His people have reported seeing the Hand roaming all around Manhattan at night over the past few weeks.
- This is the first time, though, that the Hand has taken direct action against one of his properties. Even so, they didn't just burn down the building. They lured the Hulk into it, perhaps to send him some kind of message.
- Recently, the Hand has taken down a few super-powered criminals. He doesn't admit to any of them working with or for him, but some of them fall under the heading of "Known Associates" in his police file. The ninja haven't killed any of them—just knocked them down and taken blood from them.

In any case, Tombstone wants the Hand run out of New York City, and he is willing to help the heroes make that happen. He says to call him the moment they figure out what's going on, and he will join them.

If the heroes ask him to join now, he's willing to consider it. His attorney advises against it, of course, but if the heroes succeed on an Ego vs. TN 13 action check, he agrees to accompany them.

If you don't think that dynamic would work well with your particular team of heroes, feel free to give them stacks of trouble on that check, or just don't offer them the chance to make it at all. Conversely, if you really like the idea of Tombstone accompanying the heroes around town, he can make the offer unprompted, without the heroes even having to make a check.

Either way, Tombstone tells all of his people to keep a careful watch on the heroes. Unless the characters take extraordinary precautions, someone working for the crime lord is likely to spot them anywhere in Midtown. Although those observers might not know what the heroes are doing or be able to hear what they're saying, they report the location to Tombstone immediately.

Contacting a Reporter for Leads

Art by David Marquez & Justin Ponsor

Many heroes have connections with reporters. Some of them might even be reporters themselves. Both Peter Parker and Matt Murdock, for instance, are friends with investigative journalist Ben Urich, long known as one of the best in the business.

Urich worked with Parker back when Parker was at the *Daily Bugle*. He also figured out that Matt Murdock was Daredevil but decided not to publish that story, despite how many papers it would have sold.

Over the years, Urich moved up through the ranks of reporters. Years ago, he left the *Bugle* to found the independent newspaper *Front Line*. That newspaper eventually took over the remains of the *Bugle*, which Urich now owns. However, legendary editor Robbie Robertson serves as the *Bugle*'s editor in chief—and would also make a great connection, especially for Parker, either as himself or as Spider-Man.

Whichever reporter the heroes contact, they know the following:

- The Hand had not been active in New York City for a while. (When the Punisher was in charge of them, he spent most of his time at a headquarters in Japan.) However, there have been many sightings over the past few weeks. Notably, most have been near the ruins of their old headquarters: Shadowland.
- The reporter has not been able to corroborate any of the sightings, but this is often a problem with the Hand. Ninja are trained to be sneaky and to avoid detection, even in an age where there are cameras everywhere.
- There are rumors of super-powered criminals being ambushed and knocked out but then awakening relatively unharmed. They haven't even been robbed. So far, this seems restricted to those with a Weird Science origin, with possibly a few mutants mixed in the bunch.
- Rick Jones is writing a regular celebrity column about super-powered people for the *Bugle* these days. If the reporter is with the *Bugle*, they have been trying to reach him but have not been able to do so yet.
- The fact that the hostage who was used to lure the Hulk to New York was not actually Rick Jones has yet to be reported. If the heroes share that information, the reporter thanks them for the scoop.

If the heroes promise to keep the reporter in the loop about any developments, the reporter can promise the same—if they trust the heroes. If the reporter has known a hero for years, they don't need to make a check. Otherwise, an agreement requires a Logic or Ego vs. TN 13 action check.

Contacting Rick Jones

Rick Jones knows countless super heroes, which is why the *Daily Bugle* hired him to write a regular column about super-powered people. Saving him from a gamma bomb was how Bruce Banner wound up becoming the Hulk. Jones also served as a sidekick for Captain America (Steve Rogers), was bonded with Captain Marvel (Mar-Vell) and became a long-standing member of the Avengers. In addition, he was once the gamma-powered A-Bomb.

More recently, Jones has become embroiled with symbiotes. For a while, the symbiote known as Sleeper controlled Jones without his knowledge, and he's also been bonded with the symbiote Toxin, taking on the codename Captain Spider.

Despite all that, Jones slept through the whole green alert. He's awake now, though, and his phone is blowing up with people trying to contact him. For the heroes to reach him, either he has to know them well enough to prioritize responding to them, or they have to find his home address and go speak with him in person.

If the heroes check Jones' social media, they see a statement from him that reads:

Rick Jones ✓
@realrickjones

Hey, folks! What a wild night, *eh*?

First off, I'm okay and was never in any danger. I don't know who made that video of me, but let's just say you shouldn't trust everything you see on the internet!

I hear the NYPD is on top of everything, maybe even with some super-powered help. My advice? Go back to sleep and read all about it in the *Bugle* in the morning!

If the heroes manage to reach Jones, he doesn't know much. He wasn't involved in any of this, and he doesn't really want to be. He was sleeping when it all happened, and his phone wasn't charged. Whether that's because symbiotes were messing with him or the Hand did something to it, he has no idea.

Jones doesn't want to tell anyone that he's been dealing with symbiotes, although Mary Jane Watson (currently bonded with the Venom symbiote) and Flash Thompson (Agent Anti-Venom) know.

If the heroes ask Jones to help, he's wary of getting involved. If a hero he knows asks, he agrees to join the team as Captain Spider, but under your control as the Narrator. Otherwise, it requires an Ego or Logic vs. TN 13 action check with trouble.

As with Tombstone, if you don't want Jones to join the heroes, you can exclude this as an option. And if you love the idea, you can automatically make it happen. It's in your hands.

Questioning a Criminal

If the heroes have a connection with criminals, they can contact someone who might have heard about what's happening on the streets. Alternatively, they can simply go looking for people to question.

When it comes to the Hand, most criminals are wary of saying anything about them, as they fear retribution. The Hand has a reputation for killing those who snitch on them, and few people are interested in risking such consequences.

Still, determined and persuasive heroes might have some luck.

Josie's Bar

One good subject would be Turk Barrett. He has a long history with organized crime in the area, going back to when he helped shake down Matt Murdock's father for the Fixer when Matt was just a kid. Barrett has had a wild career since then, at times stealing high-tech equipment from the Mauler and Stilt-Man to use in crimes of his own.

Barrett has had plenty of run-ins with Daredevil (Matt Murdock) and even survived an encounter with the Punisher. He's worked for the Kingpin, Mister Fear, the Hood and many others.

At one point, Barrett wound up with the Mind Stone,* which he used to ascend the ranks of Manhattan crime lords. He eventually handed it over to Doctor Strange. More recently, Barrett worked for Arcade and Mentallo, but the Spider-Men foiled that venture together.

Barrett often hangs out in Hell's Kitchen at Josie's Bar, a rough place that oozes seedy charm and seems to have avoided the area's gentrification. Matt Murdock and his friends used to patronize the place too, back when he was a younger attorney.

Assuming the heroes can get to Josie's before closing time—4 a.m. in New York City—they can find Barrett there. He's drinking by himself, trying to forget the power that he once enjoyed but has since lost.

Barrett refuses to be seen speaking with super heroes, as he doesn't want to harm his reputation, so the heroes might have to figure out a way to get him out of the bar. Alternatively, they can burst in and start cracking heads until someone talks.

***EDITOR'S NOTE:** THE MIND STONE IS A GEM THAT GRANTS THE HOLDER TELEPATHIC POWERS. IT'S FAMOUSLY ONE PART OF THE INFINITY GAUNTLET. TURK BARRETT RECEIVED THE STONE IN *INFINITY COUNTDOWN PRIME #1* (2018). FOR MORE ON THE INFINITY STONES, SEE *SECRET WARS EXPANSION*, PAGE 172.
--MINDFULLY, YR. EDITOR

Art by Chris Sprouse, Phil Noto, Lee Ferguson, Scott Hanna, Karl Story & Matt Yackey

Art by Chris Bachalo, Wayne Faucher, Livesay, Jaime Mendoza, Victor Olazaba, Tim Townsend, Al Vey & Erick Arciniega

Given the chance, Barrett slips out of Josie's back door into the alley. If the heroes are being too rough with people, he does that to flee. Otherwise, he does it hoping they might follow him or—better yet—leave the place through the front door and then swing around to find him out back.

Barrett pretends to hesitate to tell the heroes what he knows. He would love for someone to get rid of the Hand. He just doesn't want it coming back to him. He also hopes to get something out of the heroes for his trouble, even if it's just the promise of a future favor.

Barrett knows the following:

- The Hand has been taking down super-powered criminals in New York City for the past couple of weeks.
- Strangely, no one's been hurt all that badly. Some criminals claim they killed several ninja before they went down, but no one ever saw any bodies. Barrett figures those people are lying anyhow.
- The attacks are more concentrated in and around Hell's Kitchen.
- The locals have taken to avoiding the ruins of Shadowland. Some claim that it's haunted.
- One of the super-powered victims was Titania.

The Bar With No Name

The Bar, as it is often called by its patrons, is a long-established tavern in Manhattan where super-powered criminals can congregate and relax in private, without worrying about regular folks, the police or—especially—super heroes ruining their day.

There are several such places around the world, and they all share a similar set of rules:

- No fighting.
- Those who enter can consider the place a sanctuary, even if they have a record or are being hunted for crimes they committed.
- There is a hot list of names of people not allowed in under any circumstances. It can change based on behavior. The Punisher is always banned.
- There is no sign out front, and only those who know what the place is are allowed in.

The address of the Bar With No Name changes from time to time, usually after its location is compromised—like after a group of heroes visits it. The new address spreads by word of mouth among those in the know.

Currently, the entrance to the Bar With No Name is halfway down the stairwell into a Midtown subway stop. It's a nondescript door made of black glass. On it is taped a single sheet of red paper with the words "The Bar" printed in Kree letters.

Inside, there's a long bar lined with stools and just enough room for people to walk by to get into the larger space in the back, which features several booths and tables, plus a pool table with

a light that hangs low over it. Otherwise, the place is dimly lit, enough so that people have a hard time identifying each other unless they're right next to each other.

The place is often full in the evenings, but due to the green alert, there are only a few patrons here tonight. They include Crossbones, Taskmaster and Titania. (You can find profiles for each in the *Core Rulebook*.)

Crossbones and Taskmaster are jawing quietly at a table, and Titania is at the pool table, playing by herself.

Crossbones and Taskmaster have nothing to say to the heroes. As mercenaries, they know all too well that they cannot be seen as untrustworthy among other criminals. If the heroes want to cause trouble with them, it could easily lead to a fight.

The bartender—a bald man named Deke—calls for everyone to keep calm. He explains the rules to anyone who doesn't know them. The Spider-Men and the Daredevils are welcome in the place, but the Punisher is not.

The Punisher is well aware of this. A while back, he took advantage of the funeral of Stilt-Man—which was held in an older location—to attempt to kill as many patrons as possible by setting off a bomb in the Bar. He should be willing to stay out of the Bar tonight, if only so he can get to the Hand, which is a higher-priority target.

Unlike Crossbones and Taskmaster, Titania often works on either side of the law. Once she sees the heroes, she's willing to at least chat with them. When she hears they're after the Hand, she's happy to tell them everything she knows.

Titania survived being attacked by the Hand. She was walking home through Hell's Kitchen to see her husband, the Absorbing Man, when a bunch of ninja attacked her. She'd been tossing rubble around the construction zone near the ruins of Shadowland at the time and might have had more than a few drinks in her.

The ninja managed to knock her out by toppling part of the shattered building on her, and when she came to a moment later, she found them sticking a hypodermic needle in her eye. She started throwing punches at them again, and they scattered.

Titania doesn't know what the ninja were after, but they must have used the needle on her eye because her skin is so tough otherwise. She doesn't want anything to do with them and refuses to help the heroes track them down, but little would make her happier than the heroes finding the ninja and driving them out of town.

She hasn't told the Absorbing Man about any of this for fear that he'd go on a rampage and try to kill them all. She has enough troubles keeping them both out of jail without having to deal with that.

PUTTING IT ALL TOGETHER

Hopefully by now, the heroes have a decent idea of what's going on. They might not have all the answers, but they should know where to look for them.

Most of the clues lead toward Shadowland, a place that might be uncomfortable for Daredevil (Matt Murdock) to think about. Still, this could give him the chance to exorcise some personal demons, so to speak.

Skipping Past the Puzzling Part

Some players might already know about Shadowland and figure it's worth checking out straightaway. If so, they might skip over all the investigations in this chapter.

That's fine. However, that means they're also going to miss some of the clues that foreshadow the revelation that that ninja are actually clones created by the Jackal. That might make that reveal seem to come out of nowhere, but that's what happens when you leap straight to the action like that.

If you want to dissuade the heroes from poking into Shadowland before you're ready, you can remind both of the Daredevils—assuming they're among the team—that they have horrible memories of the place. Otherwise, if a Daredevil isn't on the team, you could have them swing by and tell the heroes that they've been keeping an eye on Shadowland and can go take a look at it for them while they explore other leads. Then the Daredevil can confirm the heroes' suspicions later.

Time for Tombstone

If Tombstone is not with the heroes but they report into him as requested, he curses at the news that they're heading to Shadowland. Although he knew the Hand was involved, he didn't think about Shadowland, as the old fortress has been nothing but rubble for some time.

If the heroes don't bother to check in with Tombstone, he calls them the moment they start heading toward Shadowland. He's having them watched, so he knows where they're going, and he's finally made the connection himself. He just wants to test them by seeing if they're willing to give him that information freely.

Either way, after he hangs up, he heads to Shadowland too. The heroes don't know it, but he's going to try to solve this nasty little ninja problem himself.

/4/ THE RUINS OF SHADOWLAND

Soon after the heroes determine that they need to go to Shadowland, they figure out that it's not that simple. The entire building was destroyed back when Doctor Octopus had taken over Spider-Man's body, and the place has yet to be rebuilt.

RUINED FOR GOOD

When Spider-Man (Otto Octavius) destroyed Shadowland, New York contracted Damage Control to deal with the mess. At the time, J. Jonah Jameson was the mayor of New York, and he refused to pay the full cost for the cleanup. Instead, he ordered that the place be cordoned off in the cheapest way possible: by surrounding the place with Jersey barriers and calling it a day.

Many scavengers have tried to loot the shattered building in the years since, but they never got away with much. The damage to the structure is pretty complete, and anything inside it that had any value was crushed. A few such people got hurt while trying to dig deeper into the wreckage, which isn't structurally sound, and after that, the attempts trickled off.

Damage Controlled

Under the next administration, Damage Control received more funds to properly secure the location. However, due to the fact that the Hand had operated there for so long, they took safety concerns as seriously as possible. Because they lacked the sorcerous resources to properly clean the place up, they adopted a policy of containment rather than eradication.

To this end, Damage Control built higher walls around the ruin and covered it with a gigantic tarp. Then they hired a low-rank sorcerer to place wards around it to contain any magical aftereffects. It turned out that the sorcerer was a fraud, and the wards were as effective as whistling past a graveyard.

Damage Control congratulated themselves on a job done well and under budget and then moved on to the next disaster, of which there was no lack. The Shadowland ruins have stood mostly untouched to this day.

The city has taken pains to try to repossess the land from the Hand due to their failure to secure the site and—worse yet—pay the property taxes on it, but it's been a long and expensive process. The Hand might be fractured, but for the sake of their collective reputation alone, they dislike having things taken from them. Also, they have talented and tenacious attorneys.

Despite the fact that the land sits in a valuable part of the widely gentrified Hell's Kitchen neighborhood, few investors seem confident about purchasing and developing the site, even once the city clears the way for that to happen. Their fears that the Hand might come back to claim it doesn't help, nor do the rumors that the place is haunted.

Ghosts of Shadowland

No ghosts haunt Shadowland, but the reports of strange and unexplained things happening there are not wrong. People sometimes see steam rising from the place, billowing up through the now-shredded tarps covering it. They also hear odd sounds that they cannot explain.

Some of these sounds come from the occasional unhoused person taking refuge under the tarps or from curious people exploring the ruins, but most of them—at least over the past few months—arise from the presence of the Jackal (Miles Warren).

At some point, the Jackal made several clones of Vermin (Edward Whelan) and used them to explore the vast system of tunnels, subways and sewers that runs under New York City. As part of that, he learned about the dungeons under Shadowland and set up a secret lab there.

One of the reasons the Jackal chose Shadowland was that he discovered the remains of a Hand ninja there that he could clone. He liked the idea of being able to create an army of identical minions that no one would question—at least not when they were in their ninja outfits. Also, the fact that Hand ninja often dissolved when they died—much like his clones—tickled him to no end.

Thus, he set up a lab and made clone after clone of the unnamed ninja, with modifications so they would recognize him as the leader of their faction of the Hand. This ensured that they would serve him without hesitation or question.

Once the first ninja clones were active, the Jackal questioned them about their history and their knowledge of the Hand's activities. That's

when he learned that the Hand had resurrected the Hulk at one point as a mindless creature bent only on destruction. Intrigued, he sent his first cohort of clones off to Japan to sneak into the Hand headquarters where the Hulk had been revived and see what they could find.

To the Jackal's delight, his ninja returned with DNA samples from the Hulk. These came from the short period during which the Hulk had been revived, which meant they weren't of the best quality. Despite that, the Jackal created a clone from them.

This clone was just as mindless as the Hulk had been during his temporary resurrection but entirely under the Jackal's control. Although this might have been enough for some villains, it only whetted the Jackal's appetite for creating a full-powered Hulk he could control, which set the current plot into motion.

Recently, the Spider-Men helped send the Jackal to jail for the murder of his brother, Raymond Warren, Parker's former science teacher at Midtown High School in Forest Hills, Queens. During this period, he'd created bulked-up creatures dubbed Jackal-Hulks—a half step toward his real goal—but they'd broken free from his influence.

Art by Humberto Ramos, Victor Olazaba & Edgar Delgado

While incarcerated, the Jackal decided to try again, this time without any half measures. After he escaped from jail, he returned to his secret lair beneath Shadowland and began enacting his new plan. The renewed activity from him and his clones has attracted a small bit of attention around the area, which is what some of the locals have ascribed to ghosts.

THE OLD HOME

If the Daredevils are part of the team of heroes, they can bring some interesting insight to the ruins. It's been roughly four years since the days when Murdock ruled Shadowland, but they remember it well.

Murdock's Memories

Both Daredevils remember Shadowland all too well. Even though Murdock was possessed by the Beast for part of his time here, this was once the headquarters from which he led the Hand.

Murdock also remembers everything that happened while the Beast controlled him. The process didn't shut him out so much as shove him aside.

The Others

Of the other suggested team members, all of them were involved in helping stop the Beast—with the exception of Spider-Man (Miles Morales). At the time that Daredevil ran Shadowland, Morales hadn't gotten his powers yet, much less become the new Spider-Man of Earth-1610. Everything about Shadowland sounds like ancient history to him.

Many heroes helped rescue Murdock from the influence of the Beast. Spider-Man (Peter Parker) and the Punisher took part in that conflict, but Elektra Natchios played a vital role. As a former member of the Hand herself, Elektra (her codename at the time) joined Murdock and supported him throughout his tenure as the Hand's new leader. However, after the Beast had taken over and the opportunity arose, she betrayed the demon to help save her lover.

A WICKED WEB

If Peter Parker is one of the heroes involved in this story, there are a few things that both you (the Narrator) and Parker's player should know. These details aren't guaranteed to come into play, but they might, so it's best that you're aware.

Parker's Memories

Because Peter Parker wasn't in control of his body at the time Shadowland was destroyed, he has no memories of the incident. Since his return to his body, he's researched what Octavius did while in control. He's read all sorts of reports and watched countless videos of the news, and he's pored over whatever he could find of Doctor Octopus' private notes. This crafted a picture for him that unfortunately still had countless holes.

The fact that Parker wasn't in charge of his body during that time is not widespread knowledge. He often plays it off as if he was just going through a phase at the time, pretending that he was always in control. This has backfired on him more than once, as he's been pressured or even forced to take responsibility for Octavius' actions, but it beats having to get into the complex details surrounding his secret identity.

Art by Roberto De La Torre & Matt Hollingsworth

Art by Billy Tan, Victor Olazaba and GURU-eFX

Parker's Identity

During the superhuman civil war, Spider-Man took off his mask to reveal that he was Peter Parker so he could register with the government as the new law required. He later came to regret this and had Doctor Strange, Mister Fantastic and Iron Man help him make Spider-Man's identity a secret once again.

The spell that Strange cast to accomplish this makes it so that no one knows that Parker is Spider-Man unless they actually see Spider-Man take off his mask. If they do, any memories they had that were erased by the spell come flooding back.

Some of the people involved in this adventure know Parker's secret. They are:

- Carlie Cooper
- Jackal (Miles Warren)
- Spider-Man (Miles Morales)

If the players are using the included characters, that means the Punisher and both Daredevils are not in on the secret.

The Jackal has no interest in revealing Parker's life as Spider-Man to others. He enjoys the fact that only a few people know the truth and that he is among them.

INTO THE DUNGEONS

Getting into the dungeons beneath Shadowland is impossible from directly above. Rubble blocks all the old stairwells that led down there from the upper parts of the building.

The heroes know of another way into the place: through the dungeons. Of course, it's been a long time since they came in that way.

Other Heroes

If none of the heroes were involved in Shadowland in any way, they might not know about the dungeons. In this case, there are few ways you can help them learn about them:

- The heroes could figure it out on their own by simply exploring. If they can't get into the site through the top, going underground seems like a logical next thing to attempt. Allow them the space to give that a shot.
- If they know any of the heroes who were involved in Shadowland, they could contact them and get the information directly. Those other heroes might not be able to join the story—that's up to you—but they could communicate with the heroes by voice or text at important points.
- Ben Urich knows a lot about what happened in Shadowland. He would likely be willing to share such details with the heroes, especially if they promise to tell him what they find there.

Reaching the Dungeons

The proper way to get into the dungeons beneath Shadowland is to use the "back door" (see below). Heroes (and players) are notorious for coming up with plenty of improper ways though. Here's how to handle some of the most likely ideas.

- **Through the Subway System:** Hell's Kitchen doesn't have a subway station. The closest ones are the 50th Street and 42nd Street/Port Authority stops on the A, C and E lines, which run along 8th Avenue. Heroes can enter the subway tunnels here and look for connections to the sewer system. This requires a non-combat Logic vs. TN 14 action check, and heroes can try this once every hour till they make it or give up. Heroes who have entered Shadowland by the back door before have an edge on this check.
- **Through the Sewers:** It's a smellier but shorter way to go. Heroes can pull up a nearby manhole cover and hunt around for a way to the back door. This requires a non-combat Logic vs. TN 12 action check, and they can try this once every fifteen minutes till they make it or give up. Heroes who have entered Shadowland by the back door before have an edge on this check. If they fail, they wind up smelling awful.
- **Teleportation:** If the heroes have been in Shadowland before, they should be able to use teleportation powers to get to the back door. They might even try to go deeper into the dungeons this way, but teleporting blind into an underground area can be extremely dangerous. Most teleporters should not be willing to risk it, as it can easily prove fatal.
- **Phasing:** The Hand used sorcery to protect Shadowland from phasing intruders, and this ward survived the destruction of the upper part of the place. Those who try to phase into the dungeons find that its walls are impenetrable. Still, this should make it easy for them to find the back door, as they can go up to Shadowland and walk around it—phasing through all the area around it—until they find that secret entrance.
- **Digging:** If the heroes are strong enough, they can try to dig their way to the dungeons from the rubble above. Doing so can be extremely dangerous, though, as the remains of the structure are not sound and are liable to collapse on them. If a hero tries digging, have them make a non-combat Melee vs. TN 18 action check. They must make three checks in a row to find the stairs in the Shadowland dungeons safely. If they fail, the rubble collapses on them, and they take dMarvel×4 Health damage and have trouble on any future checks.
- **Shrinking:** Heroes who can get small enough (down to miniature or microscopic size) can try to navigate a path through the rubble. Have them make a non-combat Agility vs. TN 12 action check if they are microscopic. Give them trouble if they are miniature. They must make three checks in a row to find the stairs in the Shadowland dungeons safely. If they fail, they hit a dead end and must turn back.

The Back Door

Toward the end of Murdock's time in Shadowland, the Hand knew that the heroes of the city were assembling against them. The Beast ordered all entrances to the building closed. They surrounded the place with barricades, and they sealed off the underground access tunnels that the Hand had used to move freely about Hell's Kitchen and into the rest of New York City.

Only one access tunnel remained, and only the members of the Hand knew of it. It featured a large circular hatch with a door that could have sealed a bank vault, and they were about to lock it down when Elektra betrayed them. After killing all of the guards, she let the heroes into Shadowland so they could mount an ambush against the Beast.

This included Luke Cage, Iron Fist (Danny Rand), the Punisher (Frank Castle), Shang-Chi, Spider-Man (Peter Parker), Wolverine (Logan) and Master Izo, the immortal co-founder of the Hand who had long since turned against it. Without Elektra's help, they would not have been able to get into Shadowland—or at least not quietly enough to keep from alerting everyone inside.

They left the door open behind them. That's how the Jackal eventually slunk into the place and took it as his own.

TOMBSTONE TIME

If the heroes agreed to let Tombstone accompany them, he should be with them when they reach the back door. Given a chance, he insists on coming with them into the dungeons, as he wants to have his revenge on—*ahem*, put a stop to—whoever has been messing with his people and his livelihood.

However, he also wants to have his people with him, and he contacts them to follow him to the back door. If the heroes push back against this, they might be able to get him to leave his gangsters behind—for now. This requires an Ego vs. TN 13 action check with trouble.

Here Comes the Gang

Tombstone has a large gang and can bring in plenty of guns to bear on this particular problem. However, he knows that too many people at once can just get in each other's way. As such, he calls only two gang members for each hero in the group.

The gang members come ready to fight. They wear bulletproof vests (Health Damage Reduction –1) and carry pistols. In addition, each of them has a frag grenade.

If the heroes refuse to let Tombstone bring his gang along, he pretends to give in to their demand. However, his people then know to follow him at a safe distance, tracking him via his phone.

If the gangsters get stopped by anything—like the back door being shut or a tunnel's collapse—they use their frag grenades to try to blast their way through. This can be hard to pull off, and the noise is likely to alert the heroes that someone is on their tail, but it cannot be helped.

Can't Shut Him Out

If the heroes refuse to let Tombstone accompany them, he reluctantly agrees but says they'd better not disappoint him. Then he gathers his gangsters and follows the heroes at a safe distance, just like above.

If Tombstone gets stopped by something, he tries to use his bare hands to get through it—just like the heroes could—before he has his gangsters break out the frag grenades.

Pre-Fight

Some heroes might detect Tombstone and/or the gangsters following them and decide that it's best to take them out before a confrontation with the Hand. This can be a wise move, as it could help reduce the chaos in the final fight.

However, if the gangsters go down, Tombstone calls in a backup team as soon as possible. If Tombstone himself goes down, the backup team has orders to find, rescue and revive him as soon as possible. This might leave him pretty battered for the final battle, but he's determined not to miss it.

DETERRENCE AND DEATH TRAPS

The Jackal has set up a number of secret labs over the years, and hard experience has taught him how things tend to go once they're discovered. For that reason, he's gone to great lengths to discourage anyone from finding his lab in Shadowland's dungeons, much less disturbing him there.

Breaching the Back Door

The back door itself is enough to keep most people out of the place. It is as solid as a bank-vault door. It has Health Damage Reduction –2, and it requires 40 points of damage to break.

Alternatively, a character who makes a non-combat Melee vs. TN 20 action check can tear the door off its hinges.

The door's relatively simple combination dial lock can be bypassed with a non-combat Logic vs. TN 14 action check. However, this requires the proper tools (like a stethoscope) or Heightened Senses 1 or 2.

As with the rest of the dungeon, a character cannot phase through the door. However, a character could teleport blind through it and then open it from the other side.

The inside of the back door is fitted with an alarm sensor that lets the Jackal know if it has been opened. If a character somehow manages to wind up on the other side of the door before it's opened, they can disable the alarm with a Logic vs. TN 13 action check. This gives the entire team an edge on initiative for their first combat in the dungeons.

If the heroes can't get through the door on their own (which is unlikely but possible), after they get stumped, it opens on its own and one Hand ninja for each of them slips through it and into the tunnels beyond. If the heroes defeat the ninja, they can then walk through the open door.

Art by Billy Tan, Victor Olazaba and GURU-eFX

Cameras

The Jackal has set up mini cameras throughout the dungeons. This allows him to see where anyone in the location is at all times. He can also listen through them, hearing any plans the heroes might make out loud.

Each time the heroes enter a new location in the dungeons, have them make a Vigilance check. If they get a 12 or higher, they spot the cameras watching them. If they get an 18 or higher, they spot the secret cameras that the Jackal went to great pains to hide.

Destroying a camera requires doing only 5 points of Health damage.

Traps

The Jackal has rigged a number of traps throughout the dungeons—one at the entrance to each location. He and the ninja know where they are and can avoid them easily.

Each time the heroes are about to enter a location, have them make a Vigilance vs. TN 14 action check to spot the trap. If they do, they can make a non-combat Logic vs. TN 14 action check to disable it. Otherwise, they can make a non-combat Agility vs. TN 12 action check to avoid it.

If a hero triggers the trap, it does dMarvel×2 Health damage. More importantly, though, it collapses the ceiling behind them, sealing them into the room they just entered.

Give the heroes a chance to hear the rumbling of the collapse and decide which side of the blockage they want to be on when it falls down. If they find themselves on the wrong side of the collapse, they can try to dig their way through. This requires a non-combat Melee vs. TN 18 action check. If they fail, the rubble collapses on them, and they take dMarvel×4 Health damage and have trouble on any future checks. If they succeed, they get through and can hold up the rubble long enough for the other heroes to get through too, but once they reach the other side, the passage collapses behind them again.

Heroes might also be able to teleport or phase through any blockage if they have such powers.

LOCATIONS

Inside the Shadowland dungeons, there are several discrete locations, as detailed on the Shadowland dungeons map, on the next page. Most of the place is made of rough and unpolished cut stone. There are sconces for torches set regularly along the walls of the corridors, although the Jackal has replaced many of these with LED lights connected to wires he's strung throughout the place.

Despite that, the Hand ninja prefer to use torches when they move throughout the place and into the tunnels beneath New York City. This is one of the reasons that people sometimes see smoke coming out of the rubble above.

The Jackal tolerates that for the most part, but he prefers bright lights in his lab so he can see everything that's happening.

The Entrance

The space just beyond the back door is a medium-sized chamber with enough room for people to move things in and out of the dungeons. This is where Elektra betrayed the Hand and killed many ninja working for the Beast. The place has been cleaned up since.

The Stairs

The stairs here originally led up to the main floor of Shadowland and beyond. They are now blocked by tons of rubble.

There's no path past any of this. Even if the heroes could get through the rubble, they'd only find more rubble above them.

If the heroes are really determined to find a way to get through this area, they can try some of the same methods they might have used to get down to this point. (See page 34.)

The Prison Cells

This is by far the largest part of the dungeons. The ceiling in the main area here is 20 feet tall, and two levels of cells line the passage, with a narrow walkway along each level that keeps people from falling into the filthy, stagnant water below.

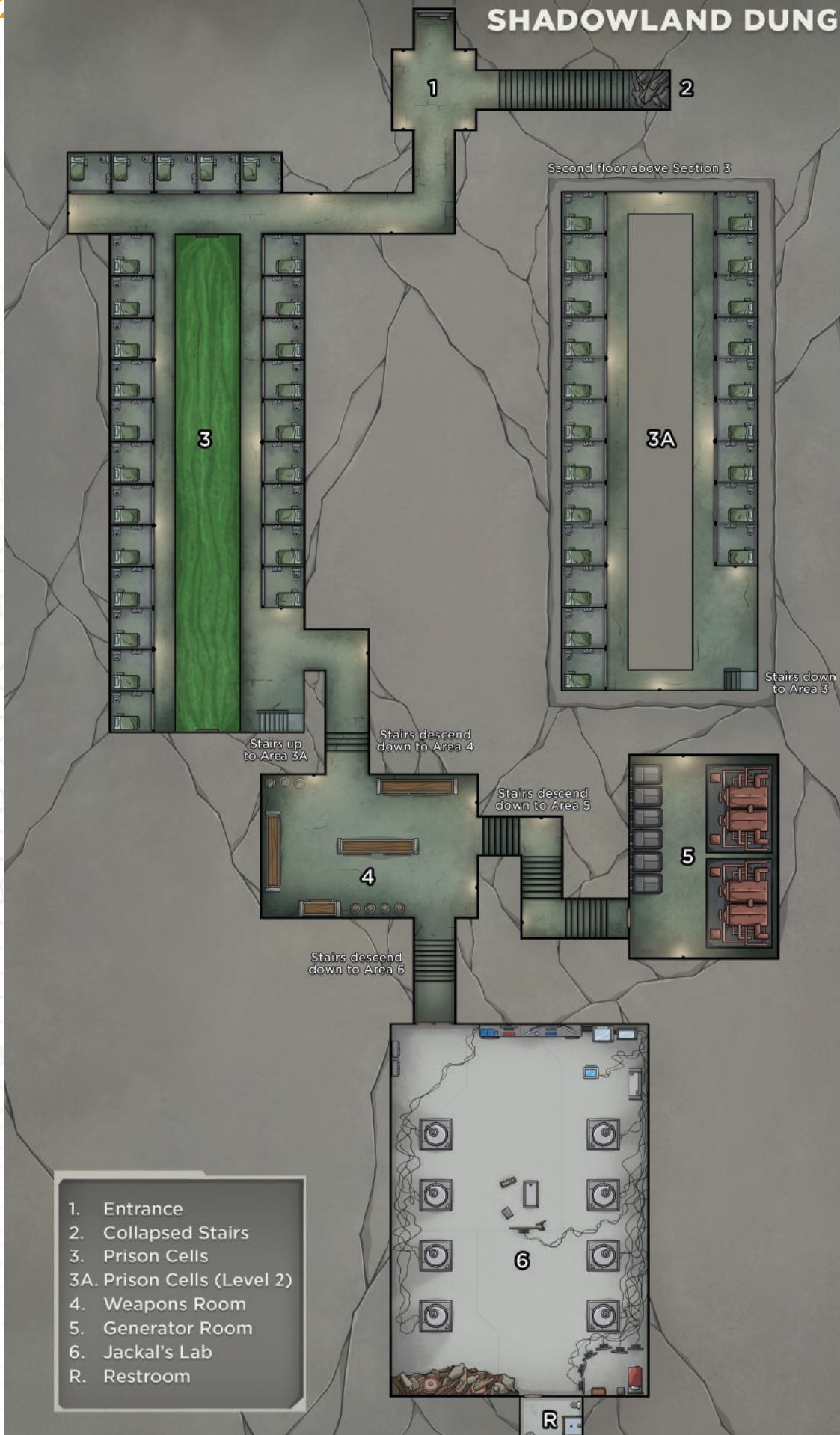
The water here is part of the New York City storm sewer system. During a storm, the water might lap at the doors of the lower level of cells, but most of the time, it simply flows through the area without much trouble. The Hand did a good job of sealing it off from easy access to the city in the final days of the Beast, but the water still gets through.

All the cells are broken open. In many places, the bars still stand, but something melted through them about halfway up, leaving plenty of room for people to move in and out. (The Ghost Rider [Johnny Blaze] did this in the days before the Beast's control over Murdock and Shadowland ended.)

The Hand ninja use a number of the cells as their living quarters, as they each have a bunk bed, a sink and a toilet. Amazingly, the plumbing in each cell still works. There are no lights in the cells, though—just lights lining the ceiling outside them.

None of the ninja have any personal effects in the cells. They are entirely devoted to their new master, the Jackal, just as they were once devoted to the Hand.

SHADOWLAND DUNGEONS



1. Entrance
2. Collapsed Stairs
3. Prison Cells
3A. Prison Cells (Level 2)
4. Weapons Room
5. Generator Room
6. Jackal's Lab
R. Restroom

Art by Billy Tan, Victor Olazaba & Christina Strain

The Weapons Room

This simple room features wooden racks on which the Hand stores their weapons. There are plenty here, left behind when the building was destroyed.

The weapons include:

- Bows and arrows
- Katanas (treat as swords)
- Sais (treat as knives)
- Shuriken (treat as thrown knives)

There are also several ninja uniforms here.

The Generator Room

When he was in charge of the Hand, Murdock knew that the city might try to cut off the power to Shadowland at some point, so he had these generators built here. The Jackal has tapped into neighbors' power lines to steal energy, but if he ever loses that source, he plans to switch to the generators.

Fortunately, the power stayed on the entire time he left his lab abandoned. Otherwise, the clones he'd left growing there might have died.

The Lab

This is where the Jackal lives and labors. He's entirely dedicated to his work and sleeps on a cot in the corner. Although he might be trying to become the next crime lord of New York, he's not well suited for the job. He only wants a massive criminal enterprise insofar as it gives him a means of control and power.

In Tombstone's eyes, the Jackal is just some brainy punk who thinks that his genius with cloning means he should control everything around him. Tombstone has taken down plenty of people like that, many of whom had a lot more education than him but none of his savvy hunger for the job.

Unless the heroes entered and made their way through the dungeons with great stealth, the Jackal likely knew they were coming and has had time to prepare a proper greeting for them in the lab.

The walls of the lab are lined with full-height cloning capsules, and the central part of the room has a dissection table where the Jackal can analyze his mistakes. The room also has other sorts of lab equipment like centrifuges, DNA sequencers, glass-doored refrigerators filled with petri dishes and so on.

A number of the cloning capsules have clones growing inside them, all in different states of development. Most of them are new ninja about ready to be deployed, and they are all labeled FUKIMOTO with a number after them, running from 42 on up. If the heroes peer into the capsules, they should see that all of the Fukimoto faces are identical, although at slightly different stages of growth.

This is a huge clue that all of the ninja are identical clones. If the heroes haven't figured it out on their own by now, you can have them each make a Logic vs. TN 13 action check. If they succeed, fill them in.

One of them, though, stands open, ready to start making a new clone as soon as the Jackal can prepare the DNA the ninja recently stole. It bears the label BANNER PRIME.

The Jackal's living area is separated from the rest of the lab with portable screens. The walls here feature several monitors that show video feeds from the cameras littering the area and beyond. There's also a framed photo of a young Gwen Stacy, someone the Jackal has long been obsessed with.

RANDOM NINJA AND GANGSTERS

While the heroes wander around the dungeons of Shadowland, there's always a chance that they could run into a random Hand ninja or a gangster who somehow wound up where they shouldn't be.

How to Check

When the heroes enter a new location that's not the lab—or if they backtrack to someplace they've been before—make a d616 roll vs. TN 13. On a success, look at the Marvel die and find that result on the table below.

Modify the results based on the situation as needed. For example, if Tombstone is already with the heroes, come up with a different encounter for a result of 6, perhaps replacing him with one of the recommended heroes if the players didn't use them.

Shadowland Encounters

Marvel Die Roll	Result
Marvel	The ninja got tired of waiting for the Jackal to order them to attack. They are hiding in the shadows here and have an edge on their initiative roll when they burst out and attack. There is one for each hero.
2	The heroes hear something in the distance ahead. Have them make a Vigilance vs. TN 10 action check. The noise seems to be coming from the lab.
3	The heroes hear something in the distance behind them. Have them make a Vigilance vs. TN 10 action check. The noise seems to be coming from the entrance.
4	A lone gangster here got separated from the others and is trying to hide from the heroes. Have the heroes make a Vigilance vs. TN 10 action check. If they succeed, they spot the gangster, who panics and starts shooting at them.
5	A lone ninja hides in the shadows near the ceiling. Have the heroes make a Vigilance vs. TN 13 action check. If they succeed, they spot the ninja, who drops on them and attacks. Otherwise, he remains hidden.
6	If the heroes were backtracking, they run into Tombstone! He says he's here to make sure the ninja problem is taken care of. If the heroes weren't backtracking, have them make a Vigilance vs. TN 13 action check to hear a noise coming from the last location they were in.

/5/ ENTER THE HULK

The Jackal doesn't make any overt moves against the heroes until they reach his lair, as shown on the map on page 43. Until then, he's content to observe them as they move through the dungeons, heading his way.

THE JACKAL'S LAB

The Jackal makes good use of the time the heroes give him to prepare, making sure both he and his Hand ninja are ready for them.

Help Me, Heroes

When the heroes enter the lab, read or paraphrase the following aloud:

> This large room—which is clearly being used now as a cutting-edge scientific lab—must have had another purpose at some point. Practice targets and training dummies lie stacked up against one side of the room, but large, glass-faced capsules line most of the rest of the walls, which are made of rough-hewn stone.
>
> The floor is made of the same stuff, with all sorts of tubes, cords and wires snaking across it, held down with gaffer tape. The ceiling stretches high overhead, difficult to see past the blazing lights that glare down from above.
>
> There are bodies growing in each of the capsules. It's hard to see them clearly through the glass, but they seem like they aren't even close to full-size or ready to spring out of their containers. Instead, they're in a sort of half-formed state, not yet given enough time to properly mature.
>
> A man in a white lab coat and a furry green costume that covers him from the ends of his pointy ears all the way to his claw-tipped toes emerges from behind medical screens at the far end of the room. *"Oh, thank god you're here!"* he says with a wide smile stuffed with jagged teeth. *"What a nightmare this has been!"*
>
> He wipes his paws on his coat and steps forward. *"I'm Professor Miles Warren, better known as the Jackal, and I need your help."*

Convenient Lies

Hand ninja hide in the rafters above the lighting, waiting for the heroes to move farther into the room. Have each hero make a Vigilance vs. TN 12 action check with double trouble. If a hero succeeds, they hear the ninja above. Otherwise, they remain oblivious.

The Jackal speaks with the heroes as if grateful they have found him. He claims that the Hand captured him shortly after he escaped from prison and have been holding him here ever since. He says they've been forcing him to make clones of various super-powered people so they can kill the clones and then resurrect them under the complete control of the Hand.

Of course, none of this is true, and the Spider-Men are sure to be extra suspicious of anything the Jackal says, given their track record with him. At any point that seems right, the Jackal can make an Ego check against the heroes' Ego defenses to see if he sounds convincing, but he has trouble against Morales and double trouble against Parker.

Even if he makes the check, the heroes don't have to believe him, of course. The check only determines if he seems like he's lying or not.

Springing the Trap

The Jackal is not particularly worried about convincing the heroes that he's telling the truth. He just wants to draw them all into the lab so the Hand ninja can surround them and attack them together.

Art by Paco Medina, Juan Vlasco & David Curiel

If Tombstone is with the heroes, he doesn't hesitate. He charges straight into the room so he can beat some answers out of the Jackal. If his gangsters are with him, they follow him in, ready to help him lean on the Jackal or start smashing stuff.

There should be one gangster for each hero's rank. If you're using the provided heroes for this adventure, that would be two gangsters for each Daredevil (who are Rank 2), two gangsters for the Punisher (who is Rank 2) and four each for the Spider-Men (who are Rank 4), for a total of fourteen.

If the heroes didn't bring Tombstone with them, this is the time for him and his people to burst into the lab. He's been following them the entire way, and his patience has run out. He wants answers from the Jackal, and he wants them now!

For his part, the Jackal hams it up, playing up the idea that he's simply an old, fragile scientist whose work has been twisted and perverted by people of ill intent. He's clearly a victim in all of this, someone who would otherwise be dedicating his incredible talents to the betterment of humanity.

Either way, once the heroes, Tombstone and the gangsters are all in the room—or when the Jackal simply feels the time is right—he throws back his head and cackles at the intruders. This stops Tombstone and his gangsters cold, and it may give the heroes reason to pause too.

"You really think I'm so helpless?" the Jackal snorts as he quits cringing and stands up to his full height. "I'm not under the thrall of the Hand. Those ninja are under mine!"

The villain snickers. *"I've been creating an army to help me take over as the new crime lord of New York City. I thought at some point, I'd have to launch an assault on the headquarters of the great and cowardly Tombstone, but look! He's done me the courtesy of saving me all that trouble. I can corner and kill him here!"*

Tombstone snarls at the conniving scientist, baring his teeth. *"Laugh long and hard, furball. Get your last licks in. I just came down here into the sewers to take care of a little vermin problem with my own two hands."*

"I have a better idea!" The Jackal spins about in delight. *"Once you're dead, I can clone you and control your entire organization through you! And maybe use you as a footstool when no one's looking!"*

That tears it for Tombstone. He launches himself at the Jackal with a roar that threatens to drown out the madman's cackling once and for all.

If the heroes let the Jackal get all the way through this speech, he gains 1 point of Karma for monologuing.

ENTER THE HAND

It's time to roll for initiative. This is the story's climactic fight.

It's Raining Ninja

As the fight starts, the Jackal's ninja leap down from the ceiling and attack. If possible, they land around the edges of the room, surrounding the heroes and Tombstone and his gangsters.

There are two Hand ninja for each hero's rank. This works the same way as the number of gangsters that Tombstone brings, only there are twice as many. Thus, if you're using the suggested heroes, there are 28 ninja.

This is, to be fair, a lot of ninja. If you're not comfortable putting that many characters into the fight at once, you can hold half of them back at first. Leave those ninja hiding in the rafters until most of their compatriots have been defeated. Then, just when the heroes think things are turning their way, the rest of the ninja leap down to join the fray.

Battle Tactics

For initiative, roll once for the ninja, once for gangsters and once each for the Jackal and for Tombstone. That should make it much easier to keep track of the order of battle.

When it comes time for the ninja to go, each of them immediately rushes toward whoever is closest. They make Melee attacks with katanas against any opponent they can reach, and they switch to Agility attacks with bows when they don't have a foe within reach.

If there are more than four ninja on a single foe, any others who would attack that same foe instead use their standard action to help a chosen ally, giving that ally an edge on their attacks. When possible, they help an ally who is more powerful than they are, like the Jackal or (as you're about to see) the Hulk clone.

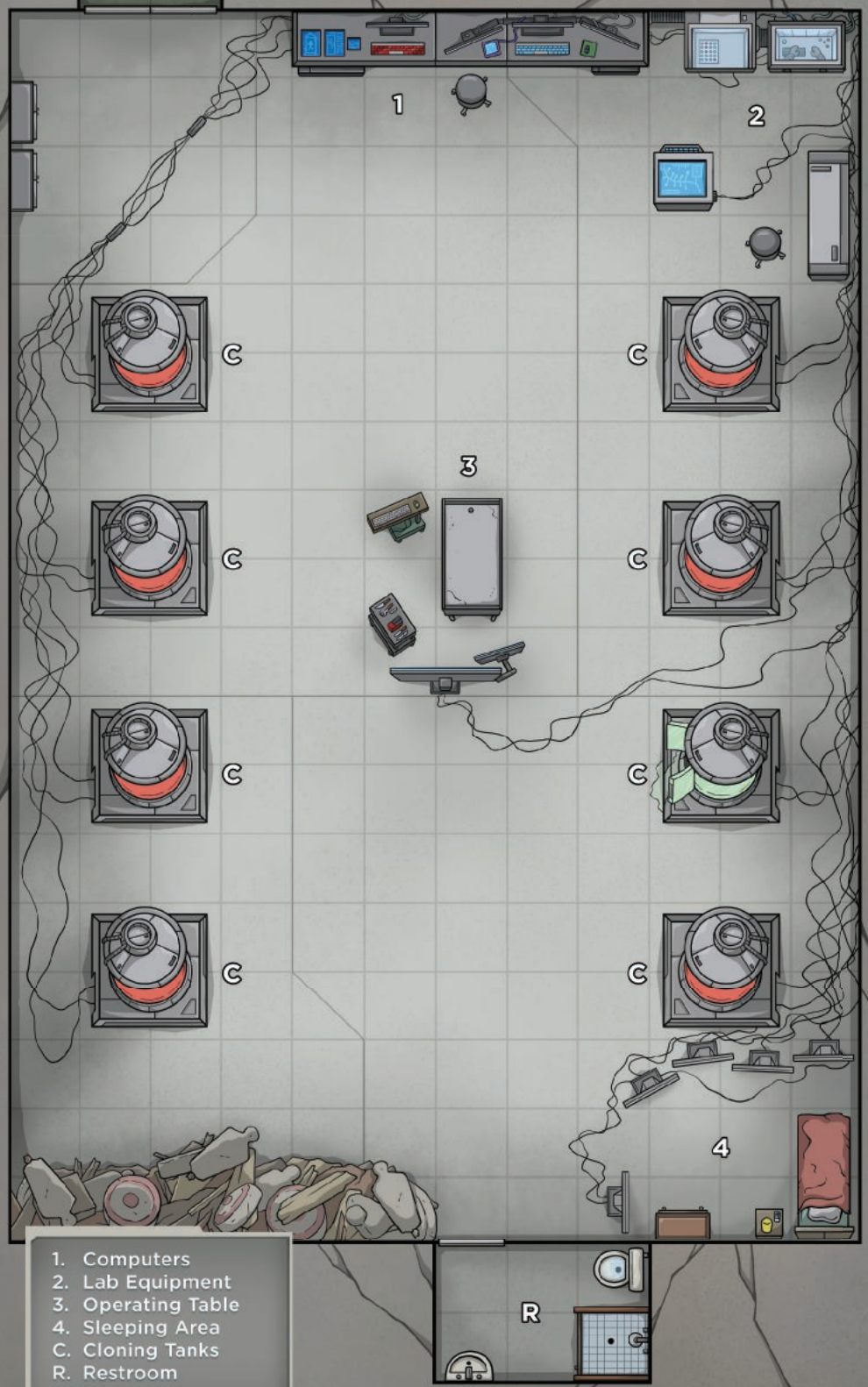
The gangsters work similarly, but they prefer to fight from a distance when possible. They make Agility attacks with pistols against their foes, and they move to Melee attacks only when they start their turn standing next to a foe. They work to help Tombstone whenever possible.

The gangsters fight the ninja at first, but the moment that any hero attacks Tombstone or a gangster, they all switch sides and fight the heroes instead.

If at all possible, Tombstone attacks the Jackal until the villain is knocked unconscious. He knows who the greater threat to his livelihood is

Art by Ruairí Coleman & Fer Sifuentes-Sujo

JACKAL'S LABORATORY



1. Computers
2. Lab Equipment
3. Operating Table
4. Sleeping Area
C. Cloning Tanks
R. Restroom

ONE SQUARE EQUALS 5FT.

at the moment, and he wants to make an example of the green-suited clown. In fact, once the Jackal is unconscious, Tombstone tries to kill him—unless a hero intervenes to stop him.

If Tombstone can't get to the Jackal but the heroes have yet to attack him or his gangsters, he attacks the ninja instead.

The Jackal tries to stay above the fray until he has a chance to spring his big surprise. He uses his Jump 1, Spider-Dodge and Wallcrawling powers to get into the room's rafters and avoid ranged attacks aimed at him, which have trouble if fired from the floor below. If cornered, he attacks, using his claws to slash at his foes.

The Hulk Ninja

At the start of the battle, pick one of the ninja at random—one in the first wave, if you're breaking things up—and keep close track of him. On that ninja's next turn after he takes damage of any kind, he lets loose an insane growl and bursts out of his ninja outfit, transforming into a clone of the Hulk. See the profiles at the end of this book for that alternate form.

This is the moment the Jackal has been waiting for. Assuming he's still able, he lets loose a loud cackle and shouts:

> *"Allow me to present my latest creation: my very own Hulk, created from the remains the Hand once resurrected! Now that I have a fresh DNA sample, my next version should be even better, but this one should be plenty to handle you all!"*

Have each hero make a Vigilance vs. TN 12 action check. Those who have fought or worked alongside the Hulk (Bruce Banner) before—which includes Parker, Murdock and the Punisher—have an edge. If they succeed, they realize that this is not the Hulk they know but a mindless version of the creature.

Elektra was one of the Avengers who fought the Hulk after the Hand had resurrected him. The moment she attacks this Hulk, she recognizes what's going on immediately. (No check needed.) She can fill the others in on that story.

In any case, this Hulk clone attacks any and all targets that are not the Jackal or ninja until they are unconscious or dead. He prioritizes anyone attacking the Jackal directly, and after that, he chooses to attack heroes over gangsters.

The Hulk clone continues to attack even if the Jackal goes down. The villain knew this might happen, and the ninja have orders to attempt to rescue him, carry him out of the lab and escape into the sewers while the Hulk clone keeps everyone else busy.

Once the Hulk clone appears, the Jackal tries to let his creation do his fighting for him. However, if he sees the chance to get in a cheap shot at any of his foes—especially Spider-Man (Peter Parker)—he takes it.

Tombstone's Betrayal

The moment the Hulk clone emerges, Tombstone's gangsters flee to the edges of the room. They know that they can't do anything against the Hulk clone with their weapons, and they would rather clear the area than get between the heroes and the Hulk clone. Instead, they spend all their standard actions helping Tombstone do whatever he wants.

For his part, Tombstone looks around and sees how the heroes are doing against the Hulk clone. He still wants to put down the Jackal if he thinks he has a chance, but he attempts this only if the Jackal is within a single movement action of him or between him and the exit from the lab.

If Tombstone has already put the Jackal down—or he doesn't think he can manage it—he races out of the room, ordering his gangsters out too. As they leave, they drop any of their remaining grenades behind them. This collapses the tunnel and seals the heroes in the lab with the Hulk clone, the ninja and any gangsters who were too slow to escape.

/6/ THE AFTERMATH

There are a number of ways this adventure could turn out. Here are some ideas for how to handle each likely outcome.

IF THE JACKAL WINS

If the Jackal and his forces triumph, the heroes are in serious trouble.

Consequences

The Jackal is pleased that he has a whole new source of DNA for his experiments, and he takes samples of each of the heroes at his mercy. If you wind up having more stories with the same heroes later, they can expect to eventually run into clones of themselves.

This sort of thing is old hat for Spider-Man (Peter Parker), who has two clones who have gone on to become heroes—of a sort—of their own: Chasm and the Scarlet Spider. Spider-Man (Miles Morales) has had clones made of him too, although those were created not by the Jackal but by the Assessor.* For other heroes, though, the idea of other versions of themselves running around and perhaps hoping to replace them can be horrifying.

In any case, if the heroes wind up with new clones of themselves, they have to find them and deal with them. This is likely to endanger any secret identities they might have, especially if those clones are inclined to side with their creator rather than their originator.

Are the heroes willing to kill the clones? Can they accept them and live beside them? Maybe they just need those copies to go far away. Or could the clones instead sub in for the originals while they head off somewhere else?

Of course, that's a long-term problem. First, the heroes have to escape from the Jackal and his ninja. The Jackal is likely to put them in repaired prison cells in the dungeon—at least until he decides what to do with them.

*EDITOR'S NOTE: THE ASSESSOR CREATED MILES' CLONES SELIM, MINDSPINNER AND SHIFT IN *MILES MORALES: SPIDER-MAN (2018) #25*.
--NAIRB NOT REVO

Art by Pepe Larraz & David Curiel

Although the Jackal might not realize it, the actual Hand is sure to see reports of Hand ninja fighting the heroes when the Hulk appeared at the warehouse. Soon after that, they send ninja to New York City to see what's happening. They inevitably check out Shadowland in the course of this, and their appearance there might give the heroes a chance to get away.

In any case, for all his faults and insane plans, the Jackal isn't usually murderous. He's more interested in his research and in gaining power than simply killing people. He could just let the heroes go. They might wake up and discover that he's abandoned Shadowland. This base has been compromised, but he can set up another somewhere else.

Follow-Ups

After the heroes escape, they still need to stop the Jackal. If he defeated Tombstone as well, he's likely to become the next crime lord of New York City, and he starts flexing his power over the local criminals before too long.

If Tombstone escaped, the Jackal is bound to come after him—and probably soon. The Jackal knows that Tombstone is aware of him now, and he can't give the crime lord the chance to mount an attack against him. Better to strike fast while Tombstone is still on his heels.

This could lead to an open gang war in the streets, with Tombstone's gangsters launching attacks during the day and the Jackal's ninja striking under the cover of night. It's sure to get bloody and perhaps harm all sorts of innocents—especially if the heroes can't put an end to it.

Either way, will the Jackal be satisfied with the heroes' DNA samples, or does he still want to harvest it from others too? What happens if he manages to make an improved clone of the Hulk with the DNA he stole? Or might he create an entire army of them under his control?

IF TOMBSTONE WINS

If the heroes lose but Tombstone beats the Jackal, it still causes all sorts of problems.

Consequences

Tombstone is merciless. Given a chance, he might simply kill the heroes and the Jackal. However, he's also smart enough to see this as a bigger opportunity than simple revenge.

When it comes to the heroes, Tombstone isn't likely to kill them unless forced to. He would rather spare their lives and have them feel like they owe him one. That's something a savvy guy like him can always use against them.

Also, Tombstone doesn't want the kind of grief that comes from killing heroes. It's one thing to whack a bunch of ninja who turn to dust afterward, but taking down five well-known heroes is a good recipe for bringing the Avengers or some other overpowered super-crew down on your head.

However, he might be willing to make an exception for the Punisher. Taking down Frank Castle could do a lot of good for Tombstone's rep. Alternatively, he might be willing to sell the man to other people who really want that honor.

As for the Jackal, Tombstone might be able to see the value in creating clones that he can control. He's happy to haul the Jackal back to one of his own safe houses and see if he can beat some solutions out of the villain—or at least beat some sense into him.

Follow-Ups

If the heroes owe Tombstone their lives, that's sure to come back to haunt them. The crime lord knows that most heroes can't be convinced to harm his foes for him or to commit a blatant crime on his behalf—but they don't always have to know the motivations behind whatever it is that he might ask them to do.

He would love to be able to tip off a hero about an upcoming score that a competitor is angling for, using them to get other players off the board. He could watch them take out a rival while keeping his hands clean.

If the heroes give in to his requests, though, where does it end? Can they ever draw a line in the sand for him? And can they trust him not to use their actions against them in the future? After all, if Tombstone can prove that the heroes have been under his thumb, he can threaten to expose their complicity at any point. That's sure to put a hit on their reputations and maybe even a target on their backs.

IF THE HEROES WIN

Ideally, the heroes triumph over both the Jackal and Tombstone, but that doesn't mean the story has to end there.

Consequences

After the battle, the heroes should call in the NYPD and even the F.B.I. to clean up the mess. The mayor—currently Luke Cage—is sure to use this as a reason to call for increased cleanup of former villain bases throughout the city. It's clearly too dangerous to let such places stand empty until ambitious squatters like the Jackal repurpose them for their own ends.

That's a high-minded goal that's sure to run into roadblocks, but the heroes can take pride in having shined a spotlight on one of the most egregious bases in the city. The Daredevils would both be thrilled to have every bit of Shadowland

carted away and see a new building go up in its place.

If the heroes captured the Jackal, that means getting another evil genius off the streets. This is a great source of comfort to Spider-Man (Peter Parker), who is always worried about villains who know his secret identity running free. Fortunately, the spell that protects his identity also keeps such villains from spreading the knowledge widely, or putting the Jackal in jail wouldn't comfort Parker much.

If the heroes capture Tombstone, his attorney—Michelle Le—gets him free on bail shortly. But the fact that he lost to a bunch of heroes won't help with his grip on New York City's underworld. In fact, it might embolden some of his more aggressive rivals—if the heroes didn't regularly knock all of them around as well.

If any of the ninja clones or the Hulk clone were killed, they turned into dust and won't be a problem for anyone. However, any surviving ninja find themselves in the hands of the police, who now have to figure out how to process the same prisoner several times over. The Hulk clone is drugged up to keep him calm and then sent off to the Raft* for safekeeping.

*EDITOR'S NOTE: THE RAFT IS A PRISON FOR SUPERHUMANS LOCATED NEAR RYKER'S ISLAND. IT FIRST APPEARED IN *ALIAS (2001) #26*.
--BIG-HOUSE BRIAN

Follow-Ups

The Hand is not happy that the Jackal tried to create his own branch of the organization outside of their control. Will they go after him in prison to make him pay?

Alternatively, they might decide they could use his help renewing their ranks after their recent war with Ares. If so, they could break him out and set him to work making more clones for them. But to ensure their control, might they want to murder him and raise him from the dead first?

Tombstone doesn't hold a grudge against the heroes unless they went out of their way to humiliate him. In his book, they did him a good turn by taking down the Jackal, even if he had to take matters into his own hands toward the end. If the heroes need something from him in the future, he's likely to give them the benefit of the doubt.

Tombstone is not going to turn into some kind of do-gooder—and he certainly won't give up or dismantle his organized crime operation—but he's willing to consider where his interests and the heroes' interests might coincide. Will he try to take advantage of that in the future? As well as he understands the heroes' motivations, can they stop him if he does?

How might the Hulk take the news of all this once he gets wind of it? Does he resent his clone and want to destroy it? Or might he instead take the relatively mindless duplicate under his wing? At the very least, he's going to be a great deal more cautious about believing what he sees on the internet from now on, and perhaps he'll trust the heroes' judgment about whether or not he should get involved if something similar happens in the future.

Art by Kasia Nie & KJ Díaz

RECOMMENDED READING

***Spider-Man—Midtown Mayhem* recaps** various chunks of Marvel history so you don't *have* to read the comics that provide the rich background for the adventure. However, if you would *like* to read those comics, here's a list of many of the issues involved. You can find them all in collections at your local comic shop or on Marvel Unlimited.

***Incredible Hulk (1962) #1*:** Rick Jones' relationship with the Hulk (Bruce Banner) goes all the way back to the Hulk's first story.

***Amazing Spider-Man (1963) #129*:** The Jackal (Miles Warren) tricks the Punisher (Frank Castle) into gunning for Spider-Man in this first appearance of both the Jackal and the Punisher.

***Amazing Spider-Man (1963) #149*:** The Jackal—who had cloned Gwen Stacy—reveals himself as Peter Parker's professor, Miles Warren, and sends a clone of Parker to fight him, with both dressed as Spider-Man. At the end of the fight, the clone is thought dead but later returns as the Scarlet Spider (Ben Reilly).

***Shadowland #1–5*:** The *Shadowland* crossover event spanned many Marvel comics in late 2010 and early 2011. The core of the story happens in this miniseries in which Daredevil (Matt Murdock) becomes corrupted as the leader of the Hand and his friends join forces to save him from the demon known as the Beast.

***Shadowland: After the Fall #1*:** Reporter Ben Urich and NYPD detective Alex Kurtz try to piece together what happened during Shadowland.

***Superior Spider-Man (2013) #14*:** While controlling the body of Peter Parker as the Superior Spider-Man, Doctor Octopus (Otto Octavius) oversees the destruction of Shadowland, forcing the Kingpin (Wilson Fisk) from the premises.

***Civil War II #3*:** At Bruce Banner's request, Hawkeye (Clint Barton) shoots him with a special arrow when he starts to become the Hulk, killing him.

***Uncanny Avengers (2015) #15–17*:** The Hand steals the corpse of Bruce Banner to resurrect him under their control. The Avengers Unity Squad spoils the spell, leaving the revived Hulk a mindless beast bent only on slaughter.

***Daredevil (2022) #1–14*:** The "Red Fist Saga" arc. With the Punisher (Frank Castle) in charge of the Hand, the two Daredevils (Matt Murdock and Elektra Natchios) re-form the Fist to stop him.

***Punisher (2022) #1–12*:** *The King of Killers* arc. The Punisher (Frank Castle) becomes the leader of the Hand when the Hand's Archpriestess promises to restore his dead wife and children to him.

***Amazing Spider-Man (2022) #39–44*:** The Gang War crossover event spanned many Marvel comics in 2024, but the core of the story happens in these six issues of *Amazing Spider-Man*. chronicling the rise of Tombstone (Lonnie Lincoln) to become the new top crime lord of New York City.

***Amazing Spider-Man (2022) #56–60*:** Spider-Man (Peter Parker) earns the gratitude of Tombstone (Lonnie Lincoln) by keeping Tombstone from murdering the woman whose testimony can send him to jail: his daughter, Janice (A.K.A. the Beetle).

***Spectacular Spider-Men #1–7*:** The Spider-Men (Peter Parker and Miles Morales) stumble upon the Jackal's (Miles Warren) experiments with making Hulked-up Jackal clones and wind up embroiled in a plot involving Arcade, Mentallo and Hammerhead.

***All-New Venom #10*:** Rick Jones bonds with Toxin, becoming Captain Spider for the first time.

BRUCE BANNER

Art by Marc Silvestri & Sunny Gho

RANK	KARMA
1	1

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
10	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	-2

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+1

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	0	10	+0
AGILITY	0	10	+0
RESILIENCE	0	10	+0
VIGILANCE	1	11	+1
EGO	0	10	+0
LOGIC	4	14	+6

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Inventor
- Iron Will
- Loner
- Scientific Expertise
- Weird

Tags

- Alternate Form (Gamma Forms)
- Black Market Access
- **Enemy:** Abomination
- **Enemy:** Leader
- Extreme Appearance (Gamma Forms)
- Green Door
- Heroic
- **Immunity:** Gamma Radiation
- Lab Access
- Public Identity
- Radioactive

POWERS

Basic

- Brilliance 2
- Inspiration
- Uncanny 2

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Robert Bruce Banner
Height: 5'10" **Weight:** 128 lbs.
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown
Gender: Male **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Scientist
Origin: Weird Science: Gamma Mutate
Teams: Avengers, S.H.I.E.L.D., U.S. Hulk Operations
Base: Mobile

History

Bruce Banner was just a mild-mannered nuclear physicist until the day he ran on to a bomb-testing range to save a young man (Rick Jones) who had wandered on to the site. Jones escaped unharmed, but the bomb blasted Banner with gamma rays. The radiation should have killed him, but instead, he gained the ability to transform into the Hulk—an unstoppable monster brought out by the scientist's own rage.

Highly powerful and just as unstable, the Hulk has been involved in more major international incidents than just about any super-powered person in existence. Some people consider him a hero. Others consider him a threat worth waging war over.

Playing As

Banner suffers from dissociative identity disorder. Depending on the circumstances, he can manifest any one of a half dozen separate personalities, each with their own corresponding Hulk form. Banner's default personality is cool, collected and deeply empathetic. The rest are all over the map. Some are impressively cunning, while others are more like angry children.

Though the media tends to focus on the dangers posed by Banner's Hulk forms, his regular human form is plenty dangerous on its own. Banner is one of the world's most brilliant scientists. He can whip up a death ray in an hour with nothing but spare parts. He usually seeks to use his skills for good, but when the situation calls for it, he can be coldly, callously logical.

BUMBLER

Art by Alessandro Miracolo & Dono Sánchez-Almara

RANK	KARMA
2	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3
Flight: 10

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +1

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
0 MELEE	10	+0
3 AGILITY	13	+3
1 RESILIENCE	11	+1
1 VIGILANCE	11	+1
3 EGO	13	+3
2 LOGIC	12	+3

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Clueless
- **Connections:** Criminal
- Extra Occupation
- Gearhead
- Inventor
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Lab Access
- Poor
- Secret Identity
- Streetwise
- Young

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Edgar Bumblaisir
Height: 5'10" **Weight:** 170 lbs.
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown
Gender: Male **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Criminal, Engineer
Origin: High Tech: Battle Suit
Teams: Buzz Boyz
Base: Brooklyn, New York City

History
As an ordinary Brooklyn teenager with a moderate talent for engineering, the future Bumbler decided to follow in the footsteps of techy super villains like the Shocker and the Tinkerer by building high-tech devices that would help him get rich fast. Taking inspiration from his favorite animal (the humble bumblebee), he threw together a simple black-and-yellow battle suit, complete with a crude set of wings and a few even cruder weapons, and set out to rob whomever he could.

Spider-Man (Miles Morales) busted the Bumbler almost immediately, without so much as breaking a sweat. Demoralized, the Bumbler took a brief break from crime before another Spider-Man villain—Rabble—lured him back in by offering to upgrade his suit and provide additional suits for his friends.

Now the new and improved Bumbler strives to either make it big or die trying. More often than not, he is joined in this futile endeavor by his cousin Vespa and their underlings, the Buzz Boyz.

Playing As
As the name suggests, the Bumbler is not particularly coordinated. He can't fight well or plan an effective heist. He can barely fly in a straight line.

In a strange way, the Bumbler's disarming nature works to his advantage. The Spider-Men know that he isn't a real threat. He's just a thrill-seeking thief—not a monster or a killer—so when they inevitably catch him, they're usually willing to let him off lightly.

POWERS

Basic
- Brilliance 1
- Inspiration

Note: Rather than traditional webs, the Bumbler's Spider-Strike, Webcasting and Webgrabbing powers rely on a weaponized form of extra-sticky honey.

BATTLE SUIT

Bumbler's Armor 2.0

Crafted by the mechanically talented Rabble, this suit combines elements of the Bumbler's original costume with modern battle suit design features.

Origin: High Tech: Battle Suit

Powers:
- Elemental Blast (Energy)
- Elemental Burst (Energy)
- Elemental Infusion (Energy)
- Flight 1
- Spider-Strike
- Sturdy 1
- Webcasting
- Webgrabbing

Restrictions:
- Flashy
- Worn

Power Value: 6

CAPTAIN SPIDER

Art by Carlos Gómez & Frank D'Armata

RANK	KARMA
3	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 5
Swim: 3
Jump: 5
Swingline: 15

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +2E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
4 MELEE	14	+5
2 AGILITY	14	+2
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
4 EGO	14	+4
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 4 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- **Anathema:** Extreme Heat/ Extreme Sonics/Anti-Venom
- Berserker
- Bloodthirsty
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Extraordinary Origin
- Fearless
- Glibness
- Quick Learner
- Symbiotic Spider-Blinder

Tags

- Alternate Form (Rick Jones)
- Black Market Access
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Names: Richard Milhouse "Rick" Jones and Toxin
Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 165 lbs.
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown
Gender: Male **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: Special Training, Symbiote: Toxin
Teams: Avengers, Gamma Flight, Teen Brigade
Base: Manhattan, New York City

History

Carnage tried to kill his first offspring, Toxin, as soon as it was born. Venom (Eddie Brock) intervened to save the symbiote, and in the ensuing chaos, the creature bonded to passing police officer Pat Mulligan.

Despite Toxin's parentage, Mulligan's influence turned the symbiote into a hero. The pair fought crime as a team until the demon Blackheart murdered Mulligan.

Since then, Toxin has been looking for a partner as compatible as Mulligan. It tried bonding with Eddie Brock, a young boy named Bren Waters and Flash Thompson before bonding with Rick Jones.

Taking inspiration from Jones' mentor, Captain America (Steve Rogers), the pair became Captain Spider. Emotionally incompatible, Jones and Toxin soon parted ways, with Toxin choosing Dylan Brock as its new host.

This profile represents Toxin during its short but eventful bonding with Rick Jones.

Playing As

Like a child with a sword, Toxin is simultaneously bloodthirsty and naive. It would help to have a strong moral influence guiding it, but after Mulligan's untimely death, the symbiote has had a hard time getting close to others.

The symbiote still hasn't fully processed the murder. It knows Mulligan is gone, but it can't stop calling Jones "Pat" anyway.

POWERS

Basic

- Disguise
- Environmental Protection
- Healing Factor
- Inspiration
- Mighty 1

Martial Arts

- Defense Stance

Spider-Powers

- Jump 1
- Spider-Sense
- Wallcrawling
- Webcasting
- Webgrabbing
- Webslinging

DAREDEVIL (ELEKTRA NATCHIOS)

Art by Mark Bagley & Edgar Delgado

RANK	KARMA
2	2

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +1

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
3 MELEE	13	+3
2 AGILITY	12	+2
2 RESILIENCE	12	+2
1 VIGILANCE	11	+1
1 EGO	11	+1
2 LOGIC	12	+2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Criminal
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Extra Occupation
- Fearless
- **Signature Attack:** Fast Attacks

Tags

- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- Hunted
- Secret Identity
- **Signature Weapon:** Sai (acts as knife; Range: Reach; Melee Damage Multiplier: +1)
- Streetwise

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Elektra Natchios
Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 130 lbs.
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Black
Gender: Female **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer, Assassin
Origin: Special Training
Teams: The Fist, The Hand, Savage Avengers
Base: Hell's Kitchen, New York City

History

Already working as an agent of the Hand, Elektra first encountered Matt Murdock while in college. Admirers of each other's skills, the two quickly fell in love, but after a tragic accident killed Elektra's father, she abandoned Murdock to return to her work as an assassin.

Years later, while working for Kingpin, Elektra encountered Murdock again, this time as the super hero Daredevil. They slowly began to rekindle their romance, and after years of fighting both together and separately—both of them being killed and resurrected multiple times—they seem to have finally gotten it together as partners. They now defend Hell's Kitchen together, both acting as Daredevil.

Playing As

Trained as an assassin, Elektra is generally a cold and private person. However, she does have a soft spot for Matt Murdock. More than anything, she is defined by the unwavering determination she shows in pursuit of her goals.

After becoming Daredevil, Elektra gave up her murderous ways. What she wants now is to atone for her past misdeeds by protecting the people of Hell's Kitchen.

POWERS

Martial Arts

- Attack Stance
- Counterstrike Technique
- Fast Strikes
- Leg Sweep

Melee Weapons (Sharp)

- Exploit
- Fast Attacks
- Vicious Attack

DAREDEVIL (MATT MURDOCK)

Art by Marco Checchetto

RANK	KARMA
2	2

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3 **Swingline:** 15	+1

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
2 MELEE	12	+2
3 AGILITY	13	+3
2 RESILIENCE	12	+2
1 VIGILANCE	11	+1
1 EGO	11	+1
2 LOGIC	12	+2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Matthew "Matt" Murdock
Height: 5'11" **Weight:** 185 lbs.
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Red
Gender: Male **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Blind
Occupation: Lawyer
Origin: Weird Science
Teams: The Fist, Defenders
Base: Hell's Kitchen, New York City

History

When Matt Murdock was just a boy, his face was splashed with a rare radioactive isotope. While the isotope cost him his sight, it enhanced all his other senses. Shortly thereafter, his father was killed by mobsters for refusing to take a fall in a mob-run boxing match. Murdock vowed revenge on all the criminals of Hell's Kitchen and began training in martial arts with the legendary sensei Stick.

As an adult, Murdock fights crime both within and without the boundaries of the law. In addition to his duties as Daredevil, he often runs a thriving law office with his longtime pal Foggy Nelson.

Playing As

Though firmly dedicated to the pursuit of justice, Murdock is not above a joke or engaging in a bit of romance. His legal clients think of him as a charming, highly considerate gentleman.

As he lacks flashy super-powers, Murdock relies on his tactical mind and his extensive martial arts training to carry him through battles against larger, stronger and more numerous opponents.

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Dealmaker
- Fearless
- Free Running
- Legal Eagle
- Public Speaking
- Weird

Tags

- Heroic
- **Obligation:** Work
- Secret Identity
- Vision Issues

POWERS

Basic

- Heightened Senses 2
- **Iconic Item:** Daredevil's Billy Club

Martial Arts

- Attack Stance
- Chain Strikes
- Do This All Day
- Fast Strikes
- Leg Sweep

ICONIC ITEM

Daredevil's Billy Club

A weapon consisting of two clubs connected by a length of wire, this can be disguised as a folding cane for the blind.

Origin: Weird Science

Powers:
- Returns When Thrown
- Swingline
- **Weapon:** Range: 15 spaces, Melee/Agility Damage Multiplier: +1.

Restrictions:
- Carried
- Flashy

Power Value: 1

HAND NINJA

Art by Jesús Saiz, Paul Azaceta & Dave Stewart

RANK	KARMA
1	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
10	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+1

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
1 MELEE	11	+1
2 AGILITY	12	+2
0 RESILIENCE	10	+0
1 VIGILANCE	11	+1
1 EGO	11	+1
0 LOGIC	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Criminal
- Determination
- **Signature Attack:** Snap Shooting

Tags

- Secret Identity
- **Signature Weapon:** Shuriken (treat as bolts; Range: 20; Agility Damage Multiplier: +1)
- **Signature Weapon:** Sword (Range: Reach; Melee Damage Multiplier: +2)
- Streetwise
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Varies
Height: Varies **Weight:** Varies
Eyes: Varies **Hair:** Varies
Gender: Varies **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Bright red ninja outfits
Occupation: Assassin
Origin: Special Training
Teams: The Hand
Base: Japan

History

The Hand is a cult composed entirely of dangerous ninja assassins, first formed in feudal Japan. Members of the Hand worship an elder god known only as the Beast. Manipulating the world from the shadows, they sow chaos wherever they roam.

For centuries, the Hand's machinations have been opposed primarily by a rival ninja organization: the Chaste. Many of the world's most famous ninja have at some point joined forces with either the Hand or the Chaste.

Playing As

Members of the Hand are fanatical and dedicated killers. Behind closed doors, the leaders of the Hand give loud and raving religious sermons, but your average Hand ninja is a professional—soft-spoken on the job and communicating only when absolutely necessary.

When most members of the Hand die, a magic spell automatically renders their corpses to dust, leaving behind no hint of their existence.

POWERS

Martial Arts

- Attack Stance
- Fast Strikes

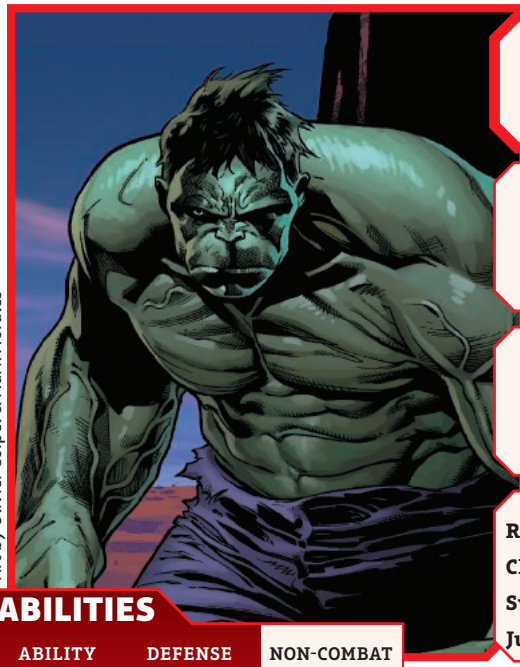
Melee Weapons (Sharp)

- Fast Attacks

Ranged Weapons

- Snap Shooting

HULK



Art by Olivier Coipel & Mark Morales

RANK	KARMA
6	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
270	-3

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
150	-2

SPEED
Run: 6
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 36

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +4

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
9 MELEE	18	+13
3 AGILITY	12	+3
9 RESILIENCE	19	+9
4 VIGILANCE	14	+4
2 EGO	12	+2
8 LOGIC	18	+10

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 10 MULTIPLIER	+	9 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 6 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel × 6 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel × 8 MULTIPLIER	+	8 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Berserker
- Big (Reach 2)
- Enduring Constitution
- Enhanced Physique
- Inventor
- Loner
- Scientific Expertise
- Weird

Tags
- Alternate Form (Gamma Forms)
- **Enemy:** Abomination
- **Enemy:** Leader
- Extreme Appearance (in Alternate Forms)
- Green Door
- **Immunity:** Gamma Radiation
- Lab Access
- Public Identity
- Radioactive

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Robert Bruce Banner
Height: Varies **Weight:** Varies
Eyes: Varies **Hair:** Varies
Gender: Male **Size:** Big
Distinguishing Features: Several distinct Hulk forms
Occupation: Scientist
Origin: Weird Science: Gamma Mutate
Teams: Avengers, S.H.I.E.L.D., U.S. Hulk Operations
Base: Mobile

History
Bruce Banner was just a mild-mannered nuclear physicist until the day he stepped out on to a bomb-testing range to save a young man (Rick Jones) who had wandered on to the site. Jones escaped unharmed, but the bomb blasted Banner with gamma rays. The radiation should have killed him, but instead, he gained the ability to transform into the Hulk—an unstoppable monster brought out by the scientist's own rage.

Highly powerful and just as unstable, the Hulk has been involved in more major international incidents than just about any super-powered person in existence. Some people consider him a hero. Others consider him a threat worth waging war over.

Playing As
Banner suffers from dissociative identity disorder. Depending on the circumstances, he can manifest any one of a half dozen separate personalities, each with their own corresponding Hulk transformation. Banner's default personality is cool, collected and deeply empathetic. The rest are all over the map. Some are impressively cunning, while others are more like angry children.

POWERS

Basic
- Anger
- Brilliance 2
- Healing Factor
- Mighty 4
- Sturdy 3
- Uncanny 2

Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber
- Crushing Grip
- Ground-Shaking Stomp
- Immovable
- Jump 3
- Quick Toss
- Smash
- Unrelenting Smash

HULK CLONE

Art by Brandon Peterson

RANK	KARMA
5	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
210	-3

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
210	-2

SPEED
Run: 7
Climb: 4
Swim: 4
Jump: 35

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +6

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	8	17	+12
AGILITY	5	14	+5
RESILIENCE	7	17	+7
VIGILANCE	6	16	+6
EGO	2	12	+2
LOGIC	-2	8	-2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 9	MULTIPLIER	+	8	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 5	MULTIPLIER	+	5	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 5	MULTIPLIER	+	2	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 5	MULTIPLIER	+	-2	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Berserker
- Big (Reach 2)
- Clueless
- **Connections:** Super Villains (Jackal and the Hand)
- Enduring Constitution
- Fearless
- Weird

Tags
- Alternate Form (Bruce Banner clone)
- Black Market Access
- Clone
- Extreme Appearance
- Green Door
- **Immunity:** Gamma Radiation
- Public Identity
- Radioactive

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: None
Height: 7' to 8' (depending on Anger levels)
Weight: 1,040 lbs. to 1,400 lbs. (depending on Anger levels)
Eyes: Green **Hair:** Green
Gender: Male **Size:** Big
Distinguishing Features: Massive green body
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: Weird Science: Gamma Mutate
Teams: None
Base: Shadowlands, New York City

History
Bruce Banner was just a mild-mannered nuclear physicist until the day he ran on to a bomb-testing range to save a young man (Rick Jones) who had wandered on to the site. Jones escaped unharmed, but the bomb blasted Banner with gamma rays. The radiation should have killed him, but instead, he gained the ability to transform into the Hulk—an unstoppable monster brought out by the scientist's own rage.

This is not that Hulk. This is a crude clone of the Hulk, created by the Jackal from partial DNA samples of the real thing. Through a combination of genetic engineering and the Hand's dark magic, the Jackal has bound this clone to his will, transforming him into a living weapon.

Playing As
The real Banner suffers from a complex form of dissociative identity disorder. Depending on the circumstances, he can manifest any one of a half dozen separate personalities, each with their own corresponding Hulk form.

This clone has only a single Hulk form—one that resembles the classic Savage Hulk. However, unlike the real Savage Hulk, this clone has no will of his own and hardly ever speaks beyond the occasional "Smash!"

POWERS

Basic
- Anger
- Environmental Protection
- Healing Factor
- Mighty 4
- Sturdy 3
- Uncanny 2

Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber
- Crushing Grip
- Ground-Shaking Stomp
- Immovable
- Jump 3
- Quick Toss
- Smash
- Unrelenting Smash

JACKAL

Art by Minck Oosterveer & David Curiel

RANK	KARMA
3	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 5 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 5	+3

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
4 MELEE	14	+5
2 AGILITY	12	+2
2 RESILIENCE	12	+2
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
1 EGO	11	+1
5 LOGIC	15	+7

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 4 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel × 5 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Combat Reflexes
- Font of Information
- Inventor
- Presence
- Scientific Expertise
- Weird

Tags

- Alternate Form
- Extreme Appearance (in Jackal form)
- Lab Access
- Public Identity
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Miles Warren
Height: 5'10" **Weight:** 175 lbs.
Eyes: Green
Hair: Gray, none (as Jackal)
Gender: Male **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Green, goblin-like appearance with retractable claws and fangs (as Jackal)
Occupation: Scientist
Origin: Weird Science
Teams: None
Base: New York City

History

Once a promising young bioengineer held in top regard by no less an authority than the High Evolutionary, Miles Warren fell into disgrace after a genetically modified jackal of his own design killed most of his family.

Unable to procure another job, Warren fell back into the safety net of so many failed scientists: higher education. Working as a biochemistry professor at New York's Empire State University, he became increasingly obsessed with student Gwen Stacy, to the point that after she died, he attempted to clone both her and her boyfriend, Peter Parker. Only after the fact did he realize that Parker was Spider-Man.

Sensing an opportunity to create incredible havoc and get revenge on one of the men he held responsible for Stacy's death, Warren created several more clones of Parker. In the guise of the Jackal, he tormented Parker and his doubles with an increasingly complex series of mind games, deliberately manipulating them into harming and even killing one another.

Though Spider-Man and his clones eventually managed to unravel Warren's initial treachery, the scientist's mind games never really ended. After imbuing himself with the ability to assume a Jackal-like alternate form, he began creating clones of himself to torment the wall-crawler. At any given moment, a dozen or more clones of the Jackal, each believing himself to be the original, may be plotting to ruin the lives of Peter Parker and his allies.

Playing As

The Jackal is a chaos lover and sadist. It's not enough for him to simply torture someone, though he's certainly not above the act. Lacking any solid identity of his own, he feels a desperate need to make his victims question their own identities.

POWERS

Basic

- Brilliance 2
- Combat Trickery
- Mighty 1

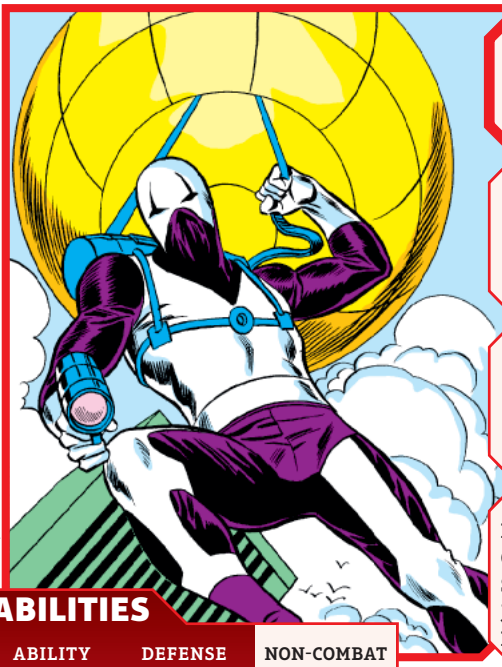
Melee Weapons (Sharp)

- Fast Attacks
- Hit & Run
- Riposte
- Vicious Attack

Spider-Powers

- Jump 1
- Spider-Dodge
- Wallcrawling

LOOTER



Art by Keith Pollard & Frank Giacoia

RANK	KARMA
3	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3
Flight: 15

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +2

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
4 MELEE	14	+5
4 AGILITY	14	+5
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
2 EGO	12	+2
0 LOGIC	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Criminal
- Extraordinary Origin
- Presence
- Tech Reliance
- Weird

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Convict
- Extreme Appearance (in battle suit)
- Public Identity
- Streetwise

POWERS

Basic
- Combat Trickery
- Mighty 1

Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber

Note: Due to the difficulty of flying under the control of a modified weather balloon, the Looter has trouble on all actions he performs in the air.

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Norton G. Fester
Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 150 lbs.
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown
Gender: Male **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Criminal
Origin: High Tech: Battle Suit, Weird Science
Teams: Spiderlings
Base: New York City

History
High school dropout and amateur scientist Norton Fester hit the jackpot when he stumbled upon a strange meteorite. Certain that it contained secrets beyond his wildest dreams, he searched for investors willing to fund research into the bizarre rock.

After being rejected, Fester grew resentful. In a moment of rage, he shattered his prized possession, exposing himself to a pocket of strange alien gas hidden inside. The gas granted him incredible strength—enough to have his revenge on all the rich investors who doubted him.

Under the codename Looter, Fester robbed dozens of banks before being brought down by Spider-Man (Peter Parker). After Fester made a serious attempt at reforming his ways, but he fell back into crime. He spent the next several years working freelance for criminal organizations.

Fester briefly went straight when the Superior Spider-Man (Otto Octavius) hired him to manage the Spiderlings, his empire of crimefighting goons. However, the Looter has since returned to his old ways.

Playing As
Unlike many super-criminals, the Looter doesn't have grand ambitions. In fact, he loots his best equipment off other villains. If a battle looks like it won't go his way, he'd rather run than risk jail time.

BATTLE SUIT

Looter's Armor
Cobbled together with stolen tech, this suit embodies the history of the Looter's greatest exploits.

Origin: High Tech: Battle Suit

Powers:
- Accuracy 1
- Elemental Barrier (Energy)
- Elemental Blast (Energy)
- Elemental Burst (Energy)
- Elemental Burst (Ice)
- Elemental Burst (Sound)
- Extended Reach 1
- Flight 1
- Sturdy 1
- Webcasting

Restrictions:
- Flashy
- Worn

Power Value: 8

PUNISHER

Art by Jesús Saiz

RANK **2**

KARMA —

HEALTH **90**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

FOCUS **90**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER **+2E**

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
3 MELEE	13	+3
3 AGILITY	13	+5
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
-1 EGO	9	-1
0 LOGIC	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	-1 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Battle Ready
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Military
- Determination
- Interrogation
- Situational Awareness

Tags

- Black Market Access
- **Linguist:** Spanish
- **Signature Weapon:** Shotgun (Range: 6; Agility Damage Multiplier: +1; can split damage across two targets)
- **Signature Weapon:** Submachine Gun (Range: 10; Agility Damage Multiplier: +1; can split damage across up to three targets; attacks within 5 or fewer spaces have trouble)
- Streetwise

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Frank Castle
Height: 6'1" **Weight:** 200 lbs.
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Black
Gender: Male **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Military
Origin: Special Training
Teams: Savage Avengers, Thunderbolts
Base: Mobile

History

Frank Castle was a decorated and exceptional Marine who fought in wars in Southeast Asia. After returning home from his final tour of duty, Castle planned to settle down with his wife and two children. Instead, his family was brutally gunned down during a mob gunfight in Central Park in Manhattan. Surviving the incident, Castle created the identity of the Punisher—an "instrument of justice"—and started a one-man war on not only those who killed his family, but also violent criminals everywhere.

Cutting a murderous swath through organized crime in New York City, the Punisher began to have run-ins with the superhuman community. Nearly tricked into killing Spider-Man by the Jackal, the Punisher has come to form uneasy alliances with super heroes when it suits his purposes. He has since taken his war across the world and even into other dimensions.

The Hand, a cult of assassins, managed to recruit Castle as their high slayer by offering to bring his family back to life and empowering him with supernatural abilities. Shot by his wife and apprehended by super heroes, the Punisher made a final escape and had a short sojourn in Weirdworld before returning to his war on crime.

Playing As

The Punisher is a man obsessed. Everything about his life has been attuned to fighting his war his way. While he has on occasion worked with others, such as Microchip and Henry Russo, he primarily works alone. Even death has not stopped Frank Castle from meting out punishment.

However, under the right circumstances, Castle can be convinced to temporarily set aside his murderous ways while working alongside morally opposed super heroes like Daredevil and Spider-Man.

POWERS

Basic

- Accuracy 2
- Slow-Motion Dodge

Ranged Weapons

- Double Tap
- Point-Blank Parry
- Snap Shooting
- Sniping
- Suppressive Fire
- Weapons Blazing

RICK JONES

Art by Carlos Gómez & Frank D'Armata

RANK	KARMA
1	1

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
10	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+1

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	1	11	+1
AGILITY	0	10	+0
RESILIENCE	0	10	+0
VIGILANCE	1	11	+1
EGO	3	13	+3
LOGIC	1	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY		
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY		
EGO	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY		
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY		

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Fearless
- Glibness
- Quick Learner

Tags

- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Richard Milhouse "Rick" Jones

Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 165 lbs.

Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown

Gender: Male **Size:** Average

Distinguishing Features: None

Occupation: Adventurer

Origin: Special Training

Teams: Avengers, Gamma Flight, Teen Brigade

Base: Manhattan, New York City

History

As a lonely and penniless orphan, Rick Jones spent his teenage years wandering the American southwest, doing odd jobs and getting into trouble. One day, on a dare, he snuck into a remote government facility in the desert, unaware that he was sneaking into an active gamma bomb test.

The bomb's designer, Bruce Banner, took the brunt of the blast in Jones' place, transforming into the Incredible Hulk. Stricken with guilt, Jones dedicated himself to making amends by following the monstrous Hulk through thick and thin.

Through his adventures with the Hulk, Jones gradually became embroiled in the larger world of super heroes. Over the years, Jones has been partners with not only the Hulk but also Captain America (Steve Rogers) and two Captain Marvels (Mar-Vell and Genis-Vell). He personally ended a Kree-Skrull war by tapping into a limitless font of cosmic power called the Destiny Force. He even spent some time as A-Bomb, a gamma-powered mutate in his own right.

Jones recently made yet another big life change by bonding with a symbiote named Toxin, rebranding himself as the intrepid Captain Spider.

This profile, however, represents Jones in his default human form.

Playing As

In spite of all the crazy stuff that's happened to him, Jones is a pretty happy-go-lucky guy. He may be over 30, but he's got the confidence and pluck of a kid with his whole life ahead of him. Managing the Hulk's emotions for so many years has taught him how to remain calm, cool-headed and empathetic even in the midst of an Earth-shattering crisis. Jones can hold his own in a battle, but his greatest strength is his ability to relate to others.

POWERS

Basic

- Inspiration

Martial Arts

- Defense Stance

SPIDER-MAN (MILES MORALES)

Art by Neeraj Menon

RANK	KARMA
4	4

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
120	—

SPEED
Run: 6
Climb: 6
Swim: 3
Jump: 6
Swingline: 18

INITIATIVE MODIFIER
+4E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
4 MELEE	19	+5
7 AGILITY	19	+7
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
4 VIGILANCE	14	+4
2 EGO	12	+2
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 5	MULTIPLIER	+	4	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4	MULTIPLIER	+	7	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 4	MULTIPLIER	+	2	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 4	MULTIPLIER	+	1	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Reflexes
- Determination
- Free Running
- Honest
- Quick Learner
- Weird

Tags
- Heroic
- **Mentor:** Spider-Man (Peter Parker)
- **Obligation:** School
- Secret Identity
- Young

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Miles Morales
Height: 5'8" **Weight:** 160 lbs.
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black
Gender: Male **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Student
Origin: Weird Science
Teams: Champions, Spider-Society
Base: Brooklyn, New York City

History

Born in an alternate universe (Earth-1610), high school student Miles Morales was bitten by a genetically modified spider that granted him amazing spiderlike abilities. After witnessing the death of his universe's Spider-Man (Peter Parker), Morales decided to take on the hero's mantle and become the new Spider-Man.

After Morales' universe was destroyed and remade, he escaped to the main Marvel Universe (Earth-616), where the Molecule Man reintegrated the teen's past life and family into his new home, even restoring some people to life. Today, Morales attends the Brooklyn Visions Academy and adventures alongside the original Spider-Man and the Spider-Society, while also establishing himself as a hero all his own.

Morales' family is aware of his vigilante activities and do their best to support him in his heroic efforts. That includes taking in his genetic clone, Shift, who intermittently acts as Morales' adventuring partner.

Playing As

Morales is an excellent student and a loyal friend. He is dedicated to making the most of his second chance at life on Earth-616 with his family. He looks up to Peter Parker as a mentor, but at the same time, he is determined to carve out his own path and become his own kind of hero. Though he's not exactly a social butterfly, Morales has a number of close friends, including his old pal Ganke Lee, his girlfriend Starling (Tiana Toomes) and former Champions teammate Ms. Marvel (Kamala Khan).

POWERS

Basic
- Evasion
- Inspiration
- Mighty 1

Illusion
- Invisibility

Spider-Powers
- Jump 1
- Spider-Dodge
- Spider-Sense
- Spider-Strike
- Venom Bash
- Venom Blast
- Venom Burst
- Venom Sword
- Wallcrawling
- Webcasting
- Webgrabbing
- Webslinging
- Webtrapping

SPIDER-MAN (PETER PARKER)

Art by Jerome Opeña

RANK	KARMA
4	4

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED
Run: 6
Climb: 6
Jump: 6
Swim: 3
Glide: 12
Swingline: 18

INITIATIVE MODIFIER
+3E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
5 MELEE	19	+6
7 AGILITY	19	+7
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
0 EGO	14	+0
4 LOGIC	14	+5

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	7 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Audience
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Sources
- Free Running
- Inventor
- Pundit
- Scientific Expertise
- Weird

Tags
- Heroic
- **Obligation:** Aunt May
- Poor
- Secret Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Peter Parker
Height: 5'10" **Weight:** 170 lbs.
Eyes: Hazel **Hair:** Brown
Gender: Male **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Journalist
Origin: Weird Science
Teams: Avengers, Fantastic Four, Spider-Army
Base: New York City

History
Bitten by a radioactive spider when he was in high school, Peter Parker gained a suite of spider-related powers. He exploited them for profit until he let a robber get away who later shot and killed his Uncle Ben in a botched burglary, driving home the lesson "with great power there must also come great responsibility." Since then, Parker has dedicated himself to fighting crime and helping those who have less power than him.

Over the years, Parker has been cloned, discovered one of his costumes was an alien symbiote and learned more about his deep connection to the Spider-Totem. At the same time, he's battled against the most colorful rogues' gallery around. Meanwhile, he's met up with several different variations of Spider-Man hailing from alternate dimensions, including the younger Miles Morales, also known as Spider-Man.

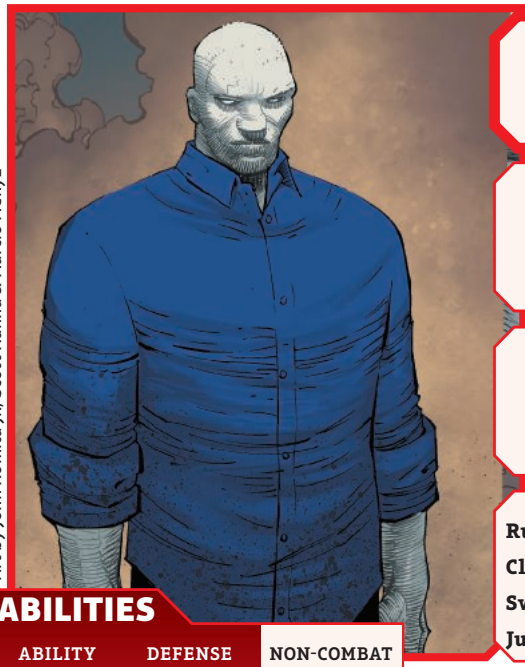
Playing As
Parker is a genius who often lets his sense of responsibility get in the way of taking care of the basics of his life. He's known for his sharp wit and his wisecracking ways, which he often uses to enrage his foes. Despite the problems that often plague his personal life, it's rare that he lets feeling sorry for himself stop him from helping others, especially when he's in costume, webswinging through the city's streets.

POWERS

Basic
- Brilliance 1
- Combat Trickery
- Evasion
- Inspiration
- Integrity
- Mighty 1
- Wisecracker

Spider-Powers
- Jump 1
- Spider-Dodge
- Spider-Sense
- Spider-Strike
- Wallcrawling
- Webcasting
- Webgliding
- Webgrabbing
- Webslinging
- Webtrapping

TOMBSTONE



Art by John Romita Jr., Scott Hanna & Marcio Menyz

RANK	KARMA
3	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+2

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
2 MELEE	12	+3
4 AGILITY	14	+5
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
3 EGO	13	+3
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- **Connections:** Criminal
- Dealmaker
- Leverage
- Presence
- Weird

Tags

- Backup
- Black Market Access
- Extreme Appearance
- Public Identity
- **Signature Weapon:** Pistol (Range: 10; Agility Damage Multiplier: +1)
- Streetwise
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Alonzo Thompson "Lonnie" Lincoln

Height: 6'7" **Weight:** 460 lbs.

Eyes: Gray **Hair:** White

Gender: Male **Size:** Average

Distinguishing Features: Hard, gray skin, partially severed nose, teeth filed down into fangs

Occupation: Criminal

Origin: Weird Science

Teams: Maggia, Sinister Six

Base: New York City

History

Lonnie Lincoln, a mid-level Maggia enforcer operating under the codename of Tombstone, pushed *Daily Bugle* editor Robbie Robertson too far. Seeking revenge on his longtime bully, Robertson shot Tombstone and shoved him into a freezer, not knowing it also contained an experimental chemical reagent that would make Tombstone as tough and strong as his namesake. With his new super-powers, Tombstone rapidly rose in the ranks of the criminal underworld to become the head of his own Harlem-based family.

The two men eventually declared a truce after Robertson discovered that his son Randy was secretly dating Tombstone's daughter, the Beetle (Janice Lincoln). The prospective in-laws both pitched in to throw a wedding for their children, only for the ceremony to be derailed by a Maggia assassination attempt on Tombstone, kicking off a citywide gang war. With help from Spider-Man (Peter Parker), Tombstone ultimately managed to defeat Madame Masque, the instigator of the attack at the wedding—and became the uncontested leader of New York City's underworld.

Playing As

Tombstone has a soft, raspy voice that pairs well with his quiet brand of evil. Unlike many other super villains, he is not a serial killer or a madman. He is a classic mastermind of organized crime, more concerned with protecting his business interests than with notions of right or wrong.

POWERS

Basic

- Accuracy 1
- Combat Trickery
- Inspiration
- Mighty 1
- Sturdy 1

Ranged Weapons

- Double Tap
- Stopping Power
- Suppressive Fire

Super-Strength

- Banging Heads
- Clobber

Tactics

- Battle Plan
- Keep Moving

NYPD OFFICER

Art by Mark Bagley, John Dell, Andy Owens & David Curiel

RANK 1 | HEALTH 30 DR: — | FOCUS 30 DR:—

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE
1 MELEE	11
1 AGILITY	11
1 RESILIENCE	11
1 VIGILANCE	11
1 EGO	11
0 LOGIC	10

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER +1 ABILITY	EGO	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER +1 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER +1 ABILITY	LOGIC	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER +0 ABILITY

POWERS
- Snap Shooting

TRAITS
- **Connections:** Police

TAGS
- Public Identity

ITEMS
Pistol: Range: 10; Agility Damage Multiplier: +1

Stun Gun: Range: 10; Agility Damage Multiplier: +1. Roll Agility against target's Resilience to inflict stun for one round; also inflicts Focus damage on a Fantastic success; otherwise does no actual damage.

HENCHMEN

TOMBSTONE'S GANGSTER

Art by Steve Lieber & Rachelle Rosenberg

RANK 1 | HEALTH 30 DR: -1* | FOCUS 30 DR:—

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE
1 MELEE	11
1 AGILITY	11
1 RESILIENCE	11
1 VIGILANCE	11
1 EGO	11
0 LOGIC	10

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER +1 ABILITY	EGO	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER +1 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER +1 ABILITY	LOGIC	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER +0 ABILITY

POWERS
- Snap Shooting

TRAITS
- **Connections:** Criminal

TAGS
- Black Market Access
- Public Identity
- Streetwise
- Villainous

ITEMS
***Bulletproof Vest:** Health Damage Reduction: –1

Frag Grenade: Affects all targets within 2 spaces of its landing place; Agility Damage Multiplier: ×2

Pistol: Range: 10; Agility Damage Multiplier: +1

HENCHMEN

THE PUNISHER'S BATTLE VAN

Art by José Luis Soares, Oren Junior & Frank D'Armata

HEALTH 100 | DAMAGE REDUCTION -2

Ground Speed: 20
Size: Huge
Passengers: 6

POWERS
- Disguise
- Speed Run 1
- Sturdy 2

WEAPONS
- No integrated weapons, but there are enough firearms and ammunition secured in the back for a small war.

PROFILE
The Punisher has owned a number of vans over the years, using them as a mobile base of operations. In the past, these were sometimes outfitted for war zones and featured integrated weapons systems. These days, the Punisher opts for an innocuous-looking armored cargo van with plenty of storage for all sorts of weapons and ammo. It comes with magnetized logos and a set of fake license plates to change its look in an instant.

The van has two regular seats up front. The rest of the space is dedicated to storage, although there are jump seats for four more people in the back.